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OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Tuesday, 11th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:51 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

[Pause]

3:01 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, in view of time constraints, we will proceed straight away to formal communication by the Speaker.

**FORMAL COMMUNICATION BY
THE SPEAKER**

**The Occurrences at the Vetting of the
Nominee for Chief Justice of the
Republic**

Hon Members, yesterday I had the pleasure and honour of receiving the leadership of the Queen Mother's Association in the country. They were led by the president of the association, the Queen Mother of the Offinso traditional area.

As a result of that, I did not observe the early part of the proceedings of the Appointments Committee. This

morning, my attention was drawn to a few things and I have come to deliver an apology on behalf of the Parliament of the Republic of Ghana to their Lordships and Ladyships and the members of the Judiciary who were present during the proceedings of the Appointments Committee held for the vetting of the nominee for the office of Chief Justice.

Hon Members, this, as I mentioned, was brought to my attention and they referred to certain comments and conduct of some Hon Members during the said proceedings, which may have appeared discourteous or disrespectful to the distinguished members of the Judiciary in attendance.

Such conduct, though not representative of the collective will of Parliament, is regrettable and inconsistent with the decorum expected of Members under the Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana.

Hon Members, the Standing Orders enjoins Members to maintain order and decorum in the House and in Committees and to refrain from the use of offensive, insulting or unbecoming language. In particular, Order 123 (3) cautions Members against imputing improper motives or using words that are disrespectful or likely to cause offence.

The Standing Orders serve as a reminder that our proceedings must always reflect the dignity and integrity of Parliament as a key organ of State. As Speaker, I wish to reaffirm Parliament's unwavering respect for the Judiciary as a co-equal arm of Government under

Article 125, Clause 1 of the 1992 Constitution, which vests the judiciary power of Ghana in the Judiciary.

The Judiciary is independent of control or direction from any person or authority.

The doctrine of separation of powers requires that all three Arms of Government, the Executive, Legislature and Judiciary, relate to one another with mutual respect and restraint.

Consequently, I have directed the Leadership of the Appointments Committee to take note of this incident and to ensure that in all future proceedings the highest standards of civility, objectivity and institutional respect are maintained.

Hon Members, Parliament cherishes the longstanding spirit of cooperation and mutual regard between our institutions. We must remain committed to strengthening that relationship in the collective service of the people of Ghana and the protection of our constitutional democracy.

Hon Members, once again, on your behalf, I extend our deepest apologies and assurances of Parliament's continued respect for the Judiciary and its esteemed members. I want to assure all of you that I will come back on this issue of decency, discipline and decorum, and this time I am coming with a hammer, not a gavel.
I thank you for your attention.

We would now take item numbered 6, *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

Hon Members, we start with the correction of *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 7th November 2025.

Page 1...7—

Hon Member, are you on your feet to make correction?

Page 8...10—

Mr Eric Edem Agbana — *rose* —

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

3:11 p.m.

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am extremely grateful. Page 10, the item numbered 11 (i)(a), line 3, after the word “available”, we should insert the word “in” before “the”.

Again, the amendment advertised in the name of the Chairperson of the Committee, by my Hon Colleague, Mr Edem Agbana, the next name, which is “Mr Isaac Boamah Nyarko”, but “Boamah-Nyarko” is a hyphenated name. So, if that could also be corrected.

The Speaker: Hon Member, you mentioned page 10, the item numbered 11 but I do not have that.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 11 had a continuation on page 10 (i).

The Speaker: So, page 9, item numbered 11, which continues on page 10. Is that what you are referring to?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am properly guided. Exactly so.

The Speaker: Alright. You said whose name was a compound name?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko

The Speaker: Thank you.

Were you up on your feet on the same corrections?

Mr Eric Edem Agbana: Yes, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Page 11...12 —

Yes, Hon Member?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, sorry but I have one on page 13 not 12.

The Speaker: So we would move to page 13.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, page 13, the item numbered 12, Motion, which reads: “That this Honourable do now adjourn”. Mr Speaker, we should insert “House” after “Honourable”

The Speaker: Yes, Table Office, there is an omission of the word “House”. So, kindly take note.

Yes, Hon Member?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, on page 13, as I would reckon, there was supposed to be an amendment captured. That amendment was proposed by me and it was carried, that has not been captured in the *Votes and Proceedings*. I just want to seek your guidance, whether that being contained in the *Official Report* suffices or it should find expression in the *Votes and Proceedings*, because it was a substantive amendment for a deletion of a certain provision of the Bill.

Specifically, the proposed amendment was to delete (c) from clause 5 of the proposed Bill. I understand it to be part of the *Official Report*, but because we are capturing key events and it has to do with amendments and the *Votes and Proceedings* captures amendment, I am just seeking your guidance, whether or not it being captured in the *Official Report* suffices or it should find expression in the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Thank you.

The Speaker: It should find expression in the *Votes and Proceedings*. So, if that actually happened yesterday, Table Office, kindly capture the amendment. And whether it was carried or negated, you also state it. Kindly take note.

Hon Members, page 13 is the last page, so, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 7th November, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, we have some visitors with us and as you can see, the Public Gallery is full. Parliament is now more visible than before, and many people are showing keen interest in whatever we do, particularly the young ones, and they are always here.

I am sure you understand why I said I will come back not with the gavel, but with the hammer. This afternoon, we have five institutions being represented here. I am going to acknowledge and welcome them to the Parliament of Ghana.

The first group is from the Amanfrom Presby Basic School. They are 61 in number, and led by Mr Martin Awuah, and this group resides in the Abuakwa South Constituency.

Please, may you be on your feet. I see that some of you are down because from the number I see up there, I started doubting that you were 61, but now, I see the young ones also standing there; because of your heights, you were not too visible. *[Laughter]*

You are warmly welcome; we are happy to have you here. I believe that the team we have, will take you around. There is a lot you will learn and this is a memorable day for you for life; you will

always recollect it. We thank you for coming. May you resume your seats.

[Pupils of Amanfrom Presby Basic School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: The second group Children's Future School, led by the head teacher, Mr Yevugah Worlanyo Kofi, and they are 101. They are coming from Kpone Katamanso Constituency.

Please, you are warmly welcome. I hope the Member of Parliament is available to see his constituents. One hundred and one is quite a large number. You may resume your seats.

[Pupils of Children's Future School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: The third group is Kitase Presby Junior High School, also led by the head teacher, by name Peter Addo Dankwa. They are 65 in numbers, and they come from the Akuapem South Constituency.

Please, you are also warmly welcome, and I hope the team will also take you through the rudiments of Parliamentary work. You may resume your seats.

[Pupils of Kitase Presby Junior High School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: The fourth group is Anjef International School, also led by the head teacher, Mr Daniel Defoe.

3:21 p.m.

They are 54 in number, and they hail from the Ashaiman Constituency. You are also warmly welcome to Parliament. You may resume your seats.

[Pupils of Anjef International School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Last but not least, we have Uncle Rich School. They are led by the head teacher, Robert Andoh, and they come from the Effutu Constituency. They are 63 in number. You are also warmly welcome. Please, resume your seats.

[Students of Uncle Rich School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Hon Members, you can see how your work is generating interest, and how important it is for us to conduct ourselves well.

With this, we will move on to — Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, it is provided in Order 67 of our Standing Orders, providing for the Order of Business, that:

“The business for a sitting, as presented by the Business Committee and adopted by the House shall be set out in the Order Paper and transacted in the following order:”

Order 67 (1) (u) indicates that we have reached the point where a complaint of

contempt of Parliament or breach of parliamentary privilege can be made. It is after the correction and adoption of *Votes and Proceedings*, which we have just completed. So, Mr Speaker, I ask for leave to make a complaint of breach of parliamentary privilege, and it is based on facts that are well known to this House. But the Rules say I must inform you. The Speaker would recall that I informed him before coming into the Chamber, that I will raise a question of breach of parliamentary privilege and contempt of Parliament. So, Mr Speaker, if I have your leave, I will proceed to put forth the facts which found the complaint that I am going to lay before this House.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — rose —

The Speaker: Are you raising a point of order, Hon Minority Chief Whip? Why are you on your feet?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, the Hon Majority Leader, a while ago, referenced Order 67, and he further went ahead to conclude on Order 67(u). Mr Speaker, the practice in this House, as I do know, and, Mr Speaker, we are at your guidance, is that we have Business for the day advertised. If we proceed further to look at Order 67(2), Mr Speaker, with your leave, it says:

“The Order of Business set out in the Order Paper may, by the leave of the Speaker, be varied at any sitting.”

My observation is, once we have Business advertised on the *Order Paper*, if it is the pleasure of the Hon Leader of

the House to seek the leave of the Speaker to vary it, he should rather come under Order 67(2) and seek your leave for that leave to be granted. But with respect, he rather quoted Order 67 and went straight ahead to settle on Order 67(u). Mr Speaker, we will need your guidance here. So, he is not making the application properly in my point of view; I may be wrong. But he should rather come under Order 67(2), seek your leave and then he can proceed. I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Order says that at a time appointed in the order of Business for making complaints of contempt of Parliament or breach of Parliamentary privilege, a Member, after having notified you prior, may make the complaint or raise a question of breach of Parliamentary privilege. If we look at the order of Business under Order 67, it goes up to about 30 different items. If we look at the items, we will see that after correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and *Official Report*, which is Order 67(1)(q), what follows is:

“(q) Statement by the Speaker

(r) Presentation of Business Statement.

(s) Statements by Ministers.

(t) Complaints of Contempt of Parliament or Breach of Parliamentary Privilege”

Mr Speaker, looking at our *Order Paper* today, clearly, instead of making a Statement, you have gone ahead to make

a formal communication to the House. So, I did not anticipate that the Speaker would be making any statement under Order 67 (1) (r). I have no plans today to present the Business Statement. No Minister has given me any indication as Leader of Government Business that he or she plans to make a statement to the House.

So, clearly, these three items listed in Order 67(1)(r) to (t) will not happen. So, automatically, we are at Order 67(1)(u), which is, “Complaints of Contempt of Parliament or Breach of Parliamentary Privilege”. And our Rules say at that point, I can seek your leave if I have given you prior notice, and even if I have not given you prior notice, I can seek your leave and you may grant me the opportunity to make a complaint of contempt of Parliament or breach of parliamentary privilege.

So, Mr Speaker, the timing and my request for audience clearly fall within our Standing Orders.

No breach of our Standing Orders can be claimed by anyone.

3:31 p.m.

The Speaker: Yes, First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

As much as we do not know the nature of the contempt the Majority Leader seeks to make, the approach and the way

he is coming before you, Mr Speaker, is wrong.

Mr Speaker, if you read Order 67, as the Majority Leader quoted, even the heading is “Order of Business”. In Order 67 (1), like he said,

“The business for a sitting, as presented by the Business Committee and adopted by the House shall be set out in the Order Paper, and transacted in the following order: ...”

Mr Speaker, we have an *Order Paper* today, and in this *Order Paper*, there is nothing that captures where he would now make an application before you to make such a Statement. Also, he presented the Business Statement to us on Friday, but there was never an indication that such a matter would arise. So, if the matter suddenly arises, then he should look for the proper Order to appear before you, for you to grant him leave.

But Mr Speaker, I strongly make the point that the Order that he quoted to seek your leave is wrong. There is nothing captured on today’s *Order Paper* that talks about the issue of contempt, where he has to vary or look at the Order now. It is not captured on our *Order Paper*.

So, the Majority Leader should look for the proper Standing Order, and then appear before you properly. If a matter suddenly arises that he wants to appear before you, there are ways that he can do it. If we come under Order 93(1), where

he wants to make a Statement of an urgent issue of public importance, which comprises the conduct of a Member that he thinks must appear before the Privileges Committee, then he can do so.

But on our *Order Paper* today, there is nothing for him to seek your leave and vary. Nothing is captured. For that matter, Mr Speaker, he is not properly before you, and I think the Majority Leader should be ruled out for the right thing to be done.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, this is a very simple matter. I do not know why it has generated a debate. My understanding of what the Majority Leader has done is to seek my leave to draw my attention to a purported conduct or act of contempt of Parliament. And he proceeded to tell you the steps he has taken before now seeking the leave.

The first step was to give me prior information; that is notice which he referred to, and the second is to get up on the Floor to seek the leave. Why is he seeking the leave? He is seeking the leave because on the *Order Paper*, we do not have an item there referring to contempt of Parliament. If we had the item on the *Order Paper*, then there would be no need for him to seek leave because it is already on the *Order Paper*. But when it is not on the *Order Paper*, you have to seek leave. The timing which he did was to look at what he said on the *Order Paper vis-a-vis* the Standing Orders. And you know from the *Order Paper*, we try to follow the Order as set

out in the Standing Orders. So, when you go through the *Order Paper*, we have: Prayers, Roll Call, National Pledge, Message from the President; all those are said. Because of time constraints, we could not go through Roll Call, National Pledge, and the rest.

The item I took on the *Order Paper* was the item numbered 5, Formal Communication by the Speaker, which is captured in the Standing Order 67(1)(g). When you follow through and you see that something that is captured in the Order is not appearing on the *Order Paper*, but you want to raise it on the Floor, then you now seek the leave of the Speaker. If it is on the *Order Paper*, you do not seek the leave of the Speaker again because it is there. That is what he did.

So, you would see that after my Formal Communication, if you go through, the next item from all the rest is what he has raised after the correction and adoption of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*, is Complaints of Contempt of Parliament or Breach of Parliamentary Privilege because we do not have any Statement and I have made my Formal Communication. There is nothing like Presentation of Business Statements: there is nothing like Statement by Ministers. So, the next one is Complaints of Contempt of Parliament or Breach of Parliamentary Privilege. That is why he stood up to seek my leave because that item is not captured on the *Order Paper*. If it were captured on the *Order Paper*, I would refer to it, and there would be no need for him to seek my leave again.

So, the Majority Leader has not done anything out of order. He is in order, and I would grant him the leave to raise the issue.

Please, Majority Leader, you may do so now. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, our Standing Orders provide in Order 31, which deals with “Specific acts of contempt of Parliament or breach of parliamentary privilege”. Before then, we have Order 30, which describes what acts constitute contempt generally. It says:

“An act or omission which

- (a) obstructs or impedes Parliament in the performance of the functions of Parliament;
- (b) obstructs or impedes the Speaker, a Member or an officer of Parliament in the discharge of the duty of the Speaker, the Member or the officer;
- (c) affronts the dignity of Parliament; or
- (d) tends either directly or indirectly to produce a result referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c)

is contempt of Parliament”

Then Order 31 deals with specific acts of contempt of Parliament or breach of parliamentary privilege. Order 31 (o) specifically is what I intend to base my complaint on. It says:

“31. Any of the following acts or conduct constitutes contempt of Parliament or breach of parliamentary privilege:

- (o) any act or omission which affronts the dignity or authority of Parliament or which tends either directly, or indirectly to bring the name of Parliament into disrepute”.

So, an act that affronts the dignity or authority of Parliament, or which tends either directly or indirectly to bring the name of Parliament into disrepute.

Mr Speaker, I think somewhere on the 22nd of July, this House passed a Resolution constituting the delegation of Ghana to the ECOWAS Parliament.

3:41 p.m.

Mr Speaker, if you recall, we had removed the name of the Hon Minority Leader and Member for Effutu, Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin, from the list of Ghana’s delegation to the ECOWAS Parliament. The Resolution of this Parliament was communicated to the ECOWAS Parliament by, I believe, your good self.

The ECOWAS Parliament convened to sit in Port Harcourt, River State in Nigeria from the 25th to 28th September, 2025. The delegation from our Parliaments, as constituted by our Resolution, went to Port Harcourt and met Osahen Afenyo-Markin, already there and refused to give way, as directed by this Parliament.

Indeed, while our nominated delegation was there and it was time to swear in Members, the ECOWAS Parliament refused to swear in Ghana’s delegation. The ECOWAS Parliament said they will not allow Ghana’s delegation to be sworn in because this Parliament had excluded the name of Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin. I had to intervene and threaten the Speaker of the ECOWAS Parliament that if my delegation returned to Ghana without being sworn in, she would receive a Resolution of the Parliament of Ghana directing Ghana to withdraw from ECOWAS itself. It was upon that threat that the Speaker of the ECOWAS Parliament then caved in and swore in four Members of our delegation.

Mr Speaker, Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin attended that session of the ECOWAS Parliament in clear defiance of a Resolution of this Parliament. That is why, I cited the provisions of Order 31 (o), which says that, “any act or omission which affronts the dignity or authority of Parliament...”, Mr Speaker, and let me emphasise, “authority of Parliament” or produces any such effect, constitutes contempt of Parliament and a breach of parliamentary privilege.”

Mr Speaker, by defying this Parliament’s Resolution excluding him from the delegation to the ECOWAS Parliament, and actually going to Port Harcourt and attending the session, he has clearly affronted the dignity and engaged in an act that constitutes an affront to the authority of this Parliament, and it is time that Osahen

Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin was put in his proper place.

Mr Speaker, I therefore rise, pursuant to the relevant Orders, to make a complaint of contempt of Parliament and a breach of parliamentary privilege and to urge you to refer the Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin to the Committee of Privileges and Immunity for him to be processed. If indeed the Committee comes to a conclusion that my contention that he indeed went to Port Harcourt and attended the session of the ECOWAS Parliament in clear defiance of our Resolution, and that, that act constitutes an affront to the authority of this House, the appropriate sanctions be executed in relation to Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, you have heard the complaint of contempt being laid before us. The Rules are clear. I will have to come back to the House with my view on this matter before I decide whether to refer the complaint to the Committee. I have that decision to make and I need to consider it before I do so. So, I will take the whole of today to consider the complaint and I will communicate my decision to the House tomorrow. The House definitely will be given ample opportunity, according to the Standing Orders of the House, to have a say in this matter. So, there is no need now for comments on this. This is his complaint he has just lodged and we will go by the Rules. So please, you will hear from me tomorrow.

With this, we will proceed to the next item numbered 7, Questions. We have a number of Questions, 10 in number, and then we have Statements too. Hon Members, as you know the practice, if it is constituency-specific, it is only the Member asking the Question who will have the opportunity to ask supplementary questions. If it is a general one—

Yes, Hon Member?

3:51 p.m.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I am grateful for the opportunity, and Mr Speaker, I admit that we are taking the item numbered 7, but I see a yawning disparity between the *Order Paper* for today and the Business Statement that was adopted last Friday.

Mr Speaker, if you may indulge me, the Business Statement as was adopted by this House had 28 Questions programmed for various days. Now, if we look at the Questions programmed for Tuesday on the Business Statement, and then the *Order Paper* for today, I see a clear disparity. For Tuesday, we have a Statement as has been advertised, then we have Questions for two sectors; the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources and the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment.

Mr Speaker, I realised that all the Questions advertised for the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources and the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment have suddenly vanished. We cannot find these Questions on the

Order Paper, and this House cannot adopt a Business Statement and suddenly make an undue amendment to the Business Statement without recourse to this House.

I saw officials of the Table Office walk up to the Government Side. Probably, they have given them some update, but they need to carry this House along. Mr Speaker, we on this Side demand answers on why these Questions have vanished from the *Order Paper*.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, if I may catch your eye. Sometimes, an Hon Member can request to catch the eye of the Speaker.

The Speaker: Why do you have to catch my ear and not my eye? — *[Laughter]* You should have struggled to catch my eye, not my ear.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, it is true that at the Business Committee we had scheduled the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources and also the Minister for Labour and Employment to appear before this House today and answer Questions. But we received a communication from the Clerk that the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is leading a delegation to Brazil to attend the Conference of the Parties (COP30) to the Climate Change Agreement. He will be arriving in the country on Monday, 10th November, 2025, and has therefore requested a rescheduling of the responses to the Parliamentary Questions.

So the Minister is leading Ghana's delegation to COP30, which is why he is unable to come and answer the Questions. I do agree with the Minority Chief Whip that ordinarily, they should have self-printed the Questions, advertised it, and then we would put in this request for rescheduling on the basis of his absence.

It is same with the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment. He had planned to come, but as we know, so much progress is being made in this country. The road infrastructure of this country is receiving a major push through the Big Push. And His Excellency the President is in the Upper West Region in the Constituency of the Minister involved in efforts to improve the road infrastructure of this country. And the Minister, because that is his Constituency, has to be there.

At the very last minute, he sent in a word that he will not be able to appear to answer the Questions and therefore, the Clerks-at-the-Table should reschedule the Questions. There is also a letter to that effect. I think the letter is with the Speaker, and he is going through it. So that is the reason I think the Table Office decided not to advertise the Question. Maybe they should still have advertised the Question so that we can request a rescheduling of the Questions.

Mr Speaker, I think that should answer the issues raised by the Hon Minority Chief Whip.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I do not envy the job of the Majority Leader; it is not an easy job. Now, the practice has been that any time such communication comes from the office of Ministers, Leadership is copied. At least the Whips are copied. On this occasion, surprisingly, we were not copied. That is the first point.

Secondly, these Ministers have deputies. My worry is that on Thursday, we are expecting the Exchequer in this House; the Minister for Finance will be here. And as we all know, when the Budget Statement is presented, we go for a post-Budget workshop, and when we are back, we debate. After that, we start taking Motions, about 40 Motions. Over the years, when these Motions are being taken, we are unable to take Questions. We already have a backlog of over 300 Questions. This is the only tool we have as Members of Parliament, the People's representatives, to elicit a response from Ministers.

The Minister is going to COP30, so is COP30 more important than coming to Parliament? No. Parliament is more important, in my view. And the Table Office goes through the motion of giving a prior notice to the Ministers, so the Minister knew ahead of time that today he would be in Parliament. Can we look at the date on the letter? The date, if the Majority Leader can tender that letter, and then mention to this House the date on that letter. Because the Minister was given prior notice. The Ministers must prioritise the work of Parliament. How are we going to dispense with over 300 Questions that are lagging? No answers.

Today, they are going to COP. The next moment, they are leading a delegation. The next moment, they are with the President in their constituency. This is Parliament, for God's sake. The President is in his constituency, so that is more of a priority than coming to answer Questions. *[Interruption]* Majority Leader, yes, the President takes precedence, I agree. In fact, that is constitutional. Is the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment the Minister for Roads and Highways?

4:01 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I think this defence that the Hon Majority Leader is trying to put out is lame; it cannot stand on its feet, and he must find better reasons to ascribe. The Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment must be called to this House.

Mr Speaker, I plead with you that you should direct that, where ever the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is, he must find his way to the Parliament of Ghana. The Minister of Lands and Natural Resources must find his way to the Parliament of Ghana. The Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment must— *[Interruption]* What are their deputies doing?

The President in his wisdom, and it is the wisdom of the framers of the Constitution, has given us the opportunity to appoint Deputy Ministers. Look at my good Friend, the Minister for Energy and Green Transition, and his Deputy, who is dutifully seated behind him. His Deputy, a very calm gentleman,

is dutifully sitting behind him, giving him all the moral support. The Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment will not be here; his Deputy will not be here. The Minister for Lands and Natural Resources will not be here, and his Deputy will—His Deputy is a Member of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, if you may indulge me, the Minister of Lands and Natural Resources' Deputy, our good Friend, who is one of our own, is a Member of Parliament. He is also not here. The two of them are attending to the Conference of the Parties (COP). Ghanaians are listening. After four years, both of them should go to Brazil for Brazilians to vote for them.

Mr Speaker, we cannot accept this reason. He must find a better reason and probably reschedule. We must reschedule because on Thursday, we will have the Minister for Finance, and we have a Committee of the Whole. We are told the Minister for Finance is already here. I plead for your directives, that these Questions must be rescheduled. They cannot be part of the backlog of over 300 Questions that are still getting dusty on shelves.

The Minister should be here tomorrow. The Minister for Lands and Natural Resources and the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment must take the next available flight from Brazil and come to Ghana. Their first duty is to represent the people of this country. That is why they were vetted by this House and not going to COP to enjoy in Brazil. They must find their way here.

He is drinking coconuts in Brazil. Mr Speaker, we need your directives.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minority Chief Whip has carved a very good image for himself in this Chamber when it comes to environmental matters. When it comes to environmental matters, if one goes through the *Hansard* of this House, he has almost no equal. He has projected himself as an environmentalist, as a man who will do whatever it takes to protect the world's climate. Every day that there is a debate in this Chamber on environmental issues, the quality of his delivery is often reported live in the media copiously.

His mastery of environmental issues is well known. It is therefore shocking that when the Minister, who is acting as Minister for Environment, Science and Technology, attends to the invitation to attend a Conference of the Parties of the Climate Change Agreement, representing the Republic of Ghana, to demonstrate the Republic of Ghana's commitment to protecting the environment and the climate, this Hon Member, who presents himself as an environmentalist, would take issue with that Minister. I am surprised,

Mr Speaker. And to create an impression that what the Minister is doing is so out of space, that in the next election Ghanaians should punish him because that Minister has attended an international conference where the world is trying to fashion out a mechanism to protect the world's climate—He expects that when the world gathers to fashion a mechanism to protect the world's

climate, that Ghana will not be heard. I am surprised, but I will not say anything. I can understand when we are doing simple politics, as we know, that there are seniors in politics. They do politics; we do politics. We will see whose politics is better politics.

Mr Speaker, I am not sure he wants to persist. Thank you.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we were expecting a very reasonable and better explanation from the Hon Majority Leader. If the Majority Leader goes on this tangent, it is very bad — *[Interruption]*. That word is withdrawn, Hon Majority Leader.

Mr Speaker, our environment is almost destroyed. *Galamsey* is everywhere, and the Hon Member thinks we do not need our Minister in Ghana, but we need him in Brazil? Is that what he is saying? When we have nothing more to call an environment, when it is being destroyed, when our water bodies are polluted, when there is *galamsey* everywhere, when people are dying as a result of our environment being destroyed, he thinks the Minister should be in Brazil?

I think the Hon Majority Leader can give us a better explanation. We can move ahead and answer the other Question, but the Hon Majority Leader should respond with reasons for saying that the Minister has attended to represent us on this— We need him in Ghana to talk about the environmental issues, to address our environment challenges and to address *galamsey*. Mr

Speaker, he should give us a better explanation than the one that he has given because it is inadequate.

4:11 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, this matter has been recurring for some time now, and the Standing Orders have elaborately detailed out the procedures on this subject matter. You need the Service led by the Clerk, Presiding Officer, that is the Speaker, and you need the House itself to be able to apply, implement and enforce the Standing Orders of Parliament.

You all know that when you issue the Question to the Minister or a Member of an Independent Constitutional Body, that is an order to the person to attend upon the House. So, Order 77(1) states it clearly, and I want to quote, that is Question Time in the House:

“77. (1) A Minister, a Member or the Head of an Independent Constitutional Body shall, by order of the House, attend a sitting of the House to answer a Question.”

That is the order of the House. It is not of the Speaker, but of the House.

In some circumstances, I represent the House or Parliament. When it comes to Sessions like these, I preside and what you ask me to do is also spelt out in the Standing Orders. So, at this time, it is the House which has ordered the person to appear before it to answer the Question.

Now, I have just been given some communication emanating from the two Ministries. One, from the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources and the other, the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment. The letter from Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources which is dated 7th November, 2025, talks about the Questions and it is signed by the acting Chief Director of that Ministry and directed to the Clerk. He has copied the Minister.

He is drawing the attention to the fact that the Minister is currently out of the jurisdiction, representing the President of the Republic of Ghana at the World Leaders Summit at COP30 in Belém, Brazil. So, he requested for a reschedule of the responses to the parliamentary Questions which he submitted. I am told that this was referred to the Leaders of the House; the Majority and Minority Leaders, and they agreed that the Questions be rescheduled.

The second one is a letter from the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment, dated 11th November, 2025. It also relates to the Questions that you were referring to. He only regrets his inability to attend upon the House on the scheduled date. The letter is signed by the Chief Director and it is directed to the Clerk-to-Parliament. He copied the Minister, Majority Leader, Majority Chief Whip and the Minority Chief Whip. That is what I have on the letter, dated 11th November, 2025. I am informed that the Leaders' attention was drawn and that they agreed that the Questions be rescheduled.

The House is led by the Leader of the House. If the Leader has truly consulted with his Colleague and they agreed that it be rescheduled, then I, as the person going to preside, should have been given some prior information. I have not been given. Based on the decision of the Leaders, the Table Office proceeded to withdraw the Questions and Answers from the Order Paper, which meant that they would have to go back to the Business Committee to be rescheduled. The Table cannot do that; it is the Business Committee that would do that.

I want to emphasise this. It is the Order of the House that the Member, Minister, or Head of the Independent Constitutional Commission attend upon the Sitting to answer Questions. How you now decide to handle that matter—Because it is out of the hands of the Speaker; it is now the Order of the House. I will come to preside, but I beg to differ the way these Orders are being treated.

The Orders of the House should be taken more seriously than is being done. It means that Members can ask Questions and Ministers can just write to say that they regret their inability to attend to answer the Question and then you take it as a good reason why the Minister should not be present to answer the Question. I do not think that is right. Please, Leader, I am saying this because we are at another critical juncture of constitutional reforms. These experiences ought to guide us as to take the decision whether to continue what we are doing or to discontinue it. That is why I am amplifying this matter.

Moreso, as the House has bent over to allow Deputy Ministers to represent their Ministers on the floor of the House to answer Questions. I say “bent over”, because by our Constitution, Deputy Ministers of Sectors are not Ministers of State. It is stated in the Constitution. But we have bent over because they are to assist the Minister. So, if the Minister says, go and assist me on the floor of Parliament, he is right to come and assist the Minister by representing the Minister.

So, the House decided to accept that and it has been the practice up to this time. So, if the Minister cannot attend, at least the Deputy Minister should come to represent the Minister. It is just to read the Answers and that will give them the opportunity to also learn on the job by responding to supplementary questions, so that the Ministers can keep their deputies abreast of what is happening at the Ministry. If we are not able to do that, then we are not grooming successors; people to take over from us. Please—

[The Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi

Buah) and the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Alhaji Yusif Sulemana) entered the Chamber]

[Uproar]

4:21 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please, I want us to take this matter seriously. Because we need to get answers to our Questions; we need people to put some priority on the Business of Parliament.

The Hon Minister who just showed up—that is not what the Minister communicated, that is what you heard from the Majority Leader, and he said they received a letter that, the Hon Minister was out of the jurisdiction to represent the President at Conference of the Parties (COP 30).

But the details of the letter, which has been given to me, and I want to read it so that we get the situation. We have to be frank with each other, we have to be truthful, we do not need to keep on deceiving ourselves.



MINISTRY
OF
LANDS AND NATURAL
RESOURCES

P. O. Box M212 Ministries - Accra
Digital Address: GA-110-0371

Kindly quote this number and date on all correspondence

My Ref. No: SCR/FA-135/267/01

Your Ref. No. _____

Date. _____

November 7, 2025

THE CLERK TO PARLIAMENT
PARLIAMENTARY SERVICE
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA.

RE: PARLIAMENTARY QUESTIONS

We refer to your letter No. OP/T/Q/127, dated October 6, 2025 on the above subject which was received today.

2. The Ministry, respectfully, wishes to inform you that the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Hon. Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah is currently out of the jurisdiction representing the President of the Republic at the world Leaders Summit at CoP30 in Belem, Brazil. He will be arriving in the country on Monday 10th November 2025 and has therefore requested for a reschedule of the responses to the Parliamentary questions.

3. Kindly accept the assurances of our highest esteem.

INNOCENT HALIGAH
AG. CHIEF DIRECTOR
FOR: MINISTER

CC: THE HON. MINISTER, MINISTRY OF LANDS AND NATURAL RESOURCES

Tel: +233(0)303 943 078
+233(0)303 941 563
Email: info@rnlr.gov.gh
Website: www.minr.gov.gh

The Acting Chief Director is Innocent Haligah. He signed for the Minister and a copy of the letter is sent to the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

That is what was communicated and given to me. So, from the letter, which is dated 7th November, 2025, the Hon Minister should have arrived in Ghana on Monday, 10th November, 2025. Today is Tuesday, 11th November, 2025.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Thank you Mr Speaker. I read this to the House and I said the Hon Minister requested for re-scheduling. I read it and actually mentioned the date of the return of the Minister. I mentioned it, go and check the records—*[Uproar]* The cameras are here, if it pleases Members, step out, play the video and they would see that I read that part of the letter giving the dates. What happened was that the Hon Minister complained that the notice was too short and we will recall that he is acting as the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology and that is the capacity in which he had to take on this assignment.

So, he complained about the shortness of the notice, and that he needed a little more time when he arrived to prepare the answer.

Mr Speaker, it is important for the public to know that Order 77, which you have read, also has a provision in Order 77(3). I read;

“A Minister, a Member or the Head of an Independent Constitutional Body shall not take more than three weeks, upon receipt of a Question from the House, to respond to the Question.”

It means that the Hon Minister has at least three weeks—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No.

Mr Ayariga: Yes, that is what the Standing Orders say. Upon receipt.

So, I explained this extensively last week, that sometimes the Questions Ministers are required to go out to the field to gather the information. The information may not be readily available at the Ministry and if we recall last week, this issue came up. I said, for instance, if you ask whether or not the building in Bador in Bawku Central, has been ripped off by a storm, the Hon Minister has to ask his Regional Director, who would in turn ask the District Director. The District Director would also have to write a report.

So, they have three weeks within which to answer when they are informed. That is the basis on which I reported to this House again, that we at Business Committee then directed the Clerks that any time they are scheduling an Hon Minister, they should make sure they have reached the Minister to ensure that the Minister has given them a firm commitment that the date they are scheduling is a date that the said Minister is available. So that they can agree on the

date, because he has three weeks. We discussed this in this Chamber and I reported our discussions at Business Committee and the Minority Chief Whip was there. We discussed these matters extensively.

Mr Speaker, we should not belabour the point. We have few Questions to answer and I believe that the real issue is that the Hon Minister was saying that the notice was short and he needed a little more time to prepare the response. Especially given that he had travelled out of the jurisdiction to represent Ghana at an international environment conference and that is what I think the letter clearly indicates.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose*—

The Speaker: I thought we had exhausted all the issues.

Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, we have not. First of all, let me profusely thank you for reminding the House on the provision of Order 77.

Mr Speaker, it is also important that we do not belittle the matter at hand. The Hon Majority Leader, last Friday, referenced Order 77(3). Today, again, he is referencing Order 77 (3). I want to challenge him to check at the Table Office. There are over 300 Questions that are outstanding. Most of the Ministers stand in defiance of the three-week provision. He should go and check. He has not checked.

Mr Speaker, what the Majority Leader should do is to carry the House along. The Majority Leader always receives the first copy of the Business Statement before other Leaders receive their copies. He knew these Questions were taken out of the *Order Paper*. The Questions that stood in the name of the Minister for Employment and Labour Relations and the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. He knew ahead of time but failed to carry Leadership along.

I got to the Chamber only to see the *Order Paper* and these Questions were miraculously missing from the *Order Paper*. How do we take this as co-Leaders? I made a point, Mr Speaker and I am grateful you re-echoed the point, that in the absence of the Minister, the Deputy can stand instead.

4:31 p.m.

Surprisingly, the Hon Minister and his Deputy all walked into the Chamber, and we were told by the Hon Majority Leader that the Hon Minister was in Brazil. I wonder if the Hon Minister came with a Brazilian presidential flight.

Mr Speaker, let me revert to Order 31(e), and it is a free counsel to our Hon Leader. Mr Speaker, with your leave, I read:

“any act or conduct calculated or intended to deceive Parliament or a Committee of Parliament;”

I find this very revealing. We have been told that the Hon Minister was in Brazil, and he was supposed to return on

Monday. Suddenly, the Hon Minister emerges in the Chamber. [*Uproar*]

Again, Mr Speaker, there is a trend emerging in this House, and we need to cure it or nip it in the bud. The Hon Majority Leader keeps saying he has told the Table Office to write to the Hon Minister; that is known and that is what they always do. He should be commending the Table Office. They have been doing this work all these years, and it will not take the Hon Majority Leader to tell them to write to the Hon Minister. That is what they do anyway.

The reasons we have 300 Questions outstanding, is for the Hon Majority Leader to answer. He is just shielding the Hon Ministers. When we go through the Motion and the Questions are programmed, he comes on the Floor to shield the Hon Ministers and gives reasons. This is why the Questions are compounding. I am repeating myself for emphasis.

Mr Speaker, they are the Frontbench. He should go and bring his Ministers. I am very worried as to why the over 300 Questions cannot be Answered. These Questions are outliving their usefulness. We file the Questions and the Hon Ministers will give excuses such as “I am in Brazil; I am drinking coconut in Brazil” and among others. What is that? We have coconut in Ghana, why do they have to go to Brazil to drink coconut? [*Laughter*]

The Speaker: Hon Members, just a five-minute suspension of Sitting.

4:34 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

4:40 p.m. — *Sitting resumed.*

The Speaker: Hon Members, I think we have had enough exchanges on this matter. The rules are very clear. In drafting these rules, we took all the issues that have been raised on the Floor into consideration, including the time in trying to gather responses from various units, Agencies, Departments and Ministries before they come before us and that is why three weeks have been given. So, you need to look at the timing and see whether it is more than the three weeks. From what we have here, it is within the three weeks.

The only issue is that once the sector Minister, Member or Head of the Independent Constitutional Body agrees to appear before the House and the Question is scheduled, it becomes an order and there must be exceptional reasons why the person will not be able to attend. In fact, we are talking about the ministry, not just a Minister. If the Minister cannot attend, as we have been doing, we allow the Deputy Minister. Unless the Member insists that he wants to hear from the Minister and not the Deputy Minister, we would allow the Deputy Minister to answer.

My other issue to the Ministers is that they should take interest or direct the heads of the ministries, that is the chief directors, as to how to couch these letters. I think that is important. By the nature of the job of Ministers, they will

not have time to write these letters themselves, so they delegate the authority to the administrative heads, and those are the chief directors. But with the way some of them write the letters, they do not attach seriousness to the work we do here. So, Ministers, kindly get in touch with the chief directors to take these things seriously. When you give instructions to them, the way they couch the letters should be such that the House would be persuaded to grant the Minister or Deputy Minister the permission to absent himself or herself. The wording of some of the letters leave much to be desired.

So, I will please urge the Leader of the House to take the comments in good faith and try as much as possible to get the Ministers and the Heads of the Independent Constitutional Bodies to appear before the House to answer the Questions. This has been dealt with, and I am reminded that in my absence, this was discussed and it is being raised again. It means it is of concern to the House. So please, let us try to resolve it. The practicality of the system we have now is such that the bureaucracy is still weak and the administration is not that responsive, and the same applies to Parliament. We are also not too responsive to queries from the public as a result of the capacity of the bureaucracy. So let us take this in good faith, but try as much as possible to enforce compliance to our Standing Orders.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take that on board. Unfortunately, the Ministry of Environment, Science and

Technology does not have a Deputy Minister, so that is one constraint. Secondly, the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment also does not have a Deputy Minister. In this instance, the Hon Minister just told me that the Question actually got to them on Friday, and he was not even in the country on Friday, but he received the communication and gave instructions that the Chief Director should request for rescheduling so that he can adequately prepare and provide the appropriate answer. But we will take on board all the concerns raised by Hon Members and we will make sure that Ministers attend to the House as scheduled. If there is a very good reason why we should reschedule, we will consider it as a House.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we want to assure the Hon Leader that we will give him the maximum cooperation. But we will not compromise on the Ministers coming to this House to answer Questions and we will demand an official correspondence. *[Interruption]* No, the Hon Majority Leader was once here; that was his seat. We are saying that they have to come to the House. We will support them, but they should make sure they come to the House and do Business. I am worried about the over 300 Questions that are getting dusty under our shelves. It is worrying. On Thursday, we are going to have the reading of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government. So, are we going to reprogram these Questions? No, these Questions are important. These Questions are also going to get dusty and added on to the outstanding Questions. Is the Hon

Majority Leader not worried about that? He should be worried about this. He is laughing. It is not funny.

The Speaker: Actually, I think the letter from the Chief Director captures all this because the Question was received at the Ministry on November 7th, so when you add three weeks, 21 plus seven will be 29. That is the limit; they are to answer within three weeks. Today is 11th November, so we are not out of the three weeks. The letter clearly stated that at the time they received the Question, the Hon Minister was out of the jurisdiction. How come it was scheduled without consulting the Hon Minister again to know whether the Hon Minister is available or not available to answer? So, this is something that I said is a weakness of the bureaucracy we have to work on. So, please — Hon Minister, do you want to have a bite?

Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I just wanted to state for the record that as a fifth-time Member of Parliament and a former Deputy Leader of this House, I take the Business of this House very seriously. In fact, it is the reason that when the information reached me, and I looked at the time limit and the Questions that

must be answered, I felt it was important that I extend it so that I can prepare properly and come to this House. That is how seriously I take this House. It is important that as we discuss this, the Clerk must also look at the time of communication and what time the Ministers will have to prepare for the Question. In this particular case, if we look at Friday and consider the fact that I was not in the country and was arriving on Monday and was expected to come one Tuesday to answer the Question—In fact, I do not take lightly the Questions as have been given to me by the civil servants. I probe further and ask questions so that I am sure that when I come here, I can give the right answers. So, I think that is why. But we take the Business of this House very seriously.

The Speaker: Thank you so much. As a former Leader, that is the right thing to do.

Hon Members, I have correspondence confirming the date that the Minister for Finance will appear before the House to present the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for and on behalf of the President. So, I want to read it for the records. The letter is dated 11th November, 2025.



MINISTRY
OF
FINANCE

P.O.Box MB 40, Ministries, Accra
Digital Address : GA-144-2024

Kindly quote this number and date on all
Correspondence

My Ref. No.: MOF/CD-PARL/11/2025

Your Ref. No.:

Date: 11th NOVEMBER, 2025

RT. HON. SPEAKER
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF GHANA
PARLIAMENT HOUSE
ACCRA

**PRESENTATION OF THE 2026 BUDGET STATEMENT AND ECONOMIC POLICY
OF GOVERNMENT TO PARLIAMENT**

Rt. Hon. Speaker, I bring you complements from the Ministry of Finance.

2. In accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana and Section 21 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), I respectfully write to request for audience to present the Budget and Economic Policy of H.E President John Dramani Mahama for the 2026 Financial year on **Thursday 13th November, 2025**.
3. I respectively seek your kind approval to facilitate the necessary arrangements for the presentation to proceed.
4. Please accept the the assurances of my highest consideration.


DR. CASSIEL ATO FORSON, (MP)
MINISTER

cc: The Secretary to the President,
Jubilee Hous Accra

The Clerk of Parliament, Accra

4:50 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, let me also acknowledge the presence of the Assembly Members from Ahanta West Municipality. They are led by the Presiding Member, Mr Isaac Bassaw. They are 49 in number.

You are welcome to Parliament. I know you are itching to be here—*[Laughter]* It is good you have started coming to get a feel of it. We, ourselves, are preparing to come to you to see how the two could work together to build up the full structure of Parliament from the national to the decentralised structures. Then the Members can use their experience and capacity to empower you to be able to work at the local level, and get the assemblies to be more efficient and more effective than we have now. Because governments would be sending much more money to the assemblies, and those moneys should be properly utilised to the benefit of the people.

So, we are happy that you found time to come, and on behalf of the House, I warmly welcome you. Please take time to go through the process, and before you leave, you would be better than you came in. Thank you so much for coming. You may resume your seats.

[Assembly Members from Ahanta West Municipality were acknowledged]

I have just been prompted about the timing. The Sitting of the House, as you know, is 2 p.m., so the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy would be read at 2:00 p.m. We would be doing

a few things in the morning, so the Minister would appear at 2:00 p.m. to present the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy.

Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, with respect, you just read to us the letter received from the Minister for Finance regarding the 2026 Budget Statement, which is to be read or presented on Thursday.

Mr Speaker, you may be aware that you admitted a Motion, which seeks to invite this House to determine — Order 195(2). Mr Speaker, this Motion has been appearing on the *Order Paper* since 11th of March. Even today, it is on page 7, titled Motion 16.

With your leave, I read:

“That pursuant to Order 127 of the Standing Orders, the Rt Hon Speaker reviews the ruling made on Tuesday, 11th March, 2025 dismissing an application made by the Hon Habib Iddrisu in accordance with Order 195(2) seeking the indulgence of the House to determine the form in which the Minister for Finance was to present the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2025 Financial Year.

Mr Speaker, with respect, I submit that our ability to deal with this Motion would bring clarity so that on Thursday, there would be no need to raise any argument. Any time this matter is raised,

the information was that you have elected to be the one to preside over this debate. So, Mr Speaker, I humbly pray that if time would permit, between today and tomorrow, this Motion is dealt with so that you give your ruling, and if your ruling in one way or the other directs which form the Budget is to be presented, then indeed the House would be bound by that clarity given by you as the Speaker. And then we can make progress.

Mr Speaker, that is my prayer on this rising. Thank you.

The Speaker: Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think the Business Committee did programme the Motion as one of the businesses that may be conducted by this House this week. Of course, once the Rt Hon Speaker has admitted it, we may try and take it. But I do not think there is any doubt regarding how the Budget is to be presented. I think the Standing Orders have dealt with this matter and it is very clear. Order 197 talks about the presentation of annual budget statement. I think the dispute is whether it should be by a Motion or by a Statement. If I recall, that was the main issue. But Order 195 is quite clear.

Mr Speaker, I think you gave a ruling on the matter. What is being pursued is a review of your decision, if I recall. So, the legal position is quite clear; it is the request for review that is pending. I do not think there is any problem on the form in which the Budget Statement should come to this House.

Mr Speaker, be that as it may, I do not know if time would permit us between now and Thursday to take that Motion. But Mr Speaker, this is a matter entirely for you to determine. You determine the Business of the House.

5:00 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I do not know why this matter has suddenly become so urgent. This is a Motion that has been on the *Order Paper* for a long time. I recall a number of times I drew the attention of Leaders to the Business, whether we are going to take this item or that item. We have been taking other items until now. It is just a day after tomorrow that we would get the Budget Statement. Now, you want us to debate this. But I am very clear in my mind about the legal position. So, if we find time tomorrow, we can debate it. There is no doubt about that. I do not have any problem.

We have given you the opportunity to relook at the earlier ruling. Maybe you may be able to persuade me to change. But at least, I have gone through it a number of times, and I think that I gave the right ruling. This is not to prejudice your submissions. But you can come. After all, it is not just for today's generation. It is for the generations yet unborn. So, we can go through it tomorrow. I have no problem with that.

May we proceed with the Business of today?

Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, because this is a House of records, I would want to put on record that we the applicants to this Motion have never gone to sleep and the *Hansard* will bear us out. Consistently, week after week, we raised this at Conclave, on the Floor and we get the response that the Speaker says at the right time he will preside. Even last week, we raised this issue about four times because it has been appearing in the *Order Paper*.

So, I just want to put it in this perspective that we have not gone to sleep on this. The Hon Majority Leader is aware the number of times we have insisted that we should deal with this thing together with Motion 15. Last Friday, I made a point here that if we had found space to determine Motion 15, perhaps there would be no need at all to raise another matter regarding whether or not when there is a pending matter in court, Parliament is stopped or otherwise.

So, Mr Speaker, we have been very vigilant and been pursuing particularly these two Motions. So, if, by the grace of God, tomorrow is available, we have always been prepared, we would make our case in this Hon House for the Mr Speaker to make his determination so that on Thursday there would not be the need to go through the matter again. We have not suddenly woken up to put pressure for this Motion to be considered.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, may we proceed? We are on item numbered 7, Questions. We have 10 Questions.

Mr Ayariga — *rose* —

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I want to seek your indulgence so that we can lay items in 9 (c) and (d).

The Speaker: Hon Members, there is an application for us to vary the Order of Business and start a public Business now. I grant leave for that. You want private business?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I just wanted to respond to the application.

Mr Speaker, with respect, the Hon Majority Leader knows that though he leads the House, but we engage. The surprise that he is springing on us, we do not want to say it is one of his several surprises, because he has many weapons under his armpit. One might not know when he would unleash any. So, in dealing with him, one must always be alert, and we will always be alert.

Much as we are not opposed to this application, we want to urge upon him to ensure that he does disclosure. Even in a criminal trial, the rule is that *ab initio*, disclose all your weapons.

Mr Speaker, I rest my case.

The Speaker: Hon Members, item numbered 9 (a), at the Commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers. The following papers to be presented by the Majority Leader.

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader—

Report of the Auditor-General on the technical and Forensic Audit on the Central Service Management Portal (CSMP) and Metric App of the National Service Authority.

Referred to the Public Accounts Committee.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, if my Friends on the other Side are not opposed, we could allow one of the Ministers present to lay item 9 (b) before the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources lays his.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Frontbench, item numbered 9 (b)?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: All right, we may proceed.

The Speaker: Hon Members, 9 (b) (i) and (ii).

By the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah) on behalf of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs—

Half Year Audit Committee Report of the Births and Deaths Registry for the period 1st January to 30th June, 2025.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nanumba North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, a while ago the Hon Majority Leader sought your leave for the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources to lay the Paper for and on behalf of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs. As we go, I wish to come under Order 97 (3), and with your leave, I read.

“A short explanatory statement shall be made by the person presenting a Paper where requested by the House or a Member upon the presentation.”

Mr Speaker, I humbly request the Hon Minister to do the needful.

The Speaker: Hon Member, you referred to Order 97 (3) which says:

“A short explanatory statement shall be made by the person presenting a Paper where requested by the House or a Member upon the presentation”.

So, it is not automatic; you have to request—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am actually requesting the Hon Minister—

The Speaker: Hon Member, your request came after I had finished with that and we were going on to the next item. You were not timeous. That is the issue.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, in this House, you interpret the Rules. The practice has always been that application is made before the referral is done. Mr Speaker, I was timeous; I was just waiting patiently.

So, Mr Speaker, with respect, I am on all fours.

5:10 p.m.

The Speaker: I am very clear on this matter. When the Hon Majority Leader requested, in fact, he even referred to you as “his Friends opposite”, whether they will not object to another Minister presenting the Paper on behalf of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs. Luckily, you stood up and said you had no objection. And so, I read, and he laid the Paper.

Then, I went to the next item, and that is when you then rose to try to submit. And I said, you were not timeous because the time he laid the Paper was the time you should have requested for him to say something as a short

explanatory statement. But you did not do that.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, if the Minister did not lay the Paper, I would not have a basis.

The Speaker: That is what I said. I said immediately he laid the Paper, that is when you should have asked. Hon Member, maybe you were not paying attention.

Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I saw the drama on that Side. I can tell you what I saw. He got up and had no objection to the Paper being laid by the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources on behalf of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs. And in not objecting, he did not add any conditions.

But afterwards, I saw the rules being ferried to him, then he saw the opportunity, believing that, being the Minister not responsible for that sector, the Minister might have challenges. But Mr Speaker, these are statutory audit reports. And this House has been laying and referring these statutory audit reports to the various Committees. So I do not think that we should belabour the point.

We still have 10 Questions to ask. And if we make it difficult for Question Time to start, we will have a backlog of 300 Questions. And then every day, we will complain about the 300 Questions. So I think we should let Business proceed.

The Speaker: Yes?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, my Leader just made a comment, which I find quite unfortunate. I have my rule books with me always. This is the Standing Order, and this is the Constitution of the Republic. I carry them every time; every day, they are in my bag. So he should not say that the rules were just ferried to me. No, Majority Leader. I take offence at that.

I am a dutiful Member of Parliament. I pay attention to processes on the Floor. So he should not say the rules were just ferried to me. I knew what I was doing. I would not belabour the point. But the point was that if the Paper is not laid, how do I come in to activate Order 97(3)? I will not. I cannot do nothing on nothing; it cannot be done.

Mr Speaker, whatever it is, we will not litigate on this matter. He should proceed. That is how magnanimous we can get. He should proceed and execute his Business. I always carry my Standing Orders and Constitution. I wish he would take notice of that. He sees me always carrying my Orders, so he should not say they were just ferried to me. That is not right.

The Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, I always see you carrying your Standing Orders and Constitution. In fact, this morning, you referred to it a number of times. That is true. The only place I disagree with you and I am trying to draw your attention to is that after the Paper is laid, you can make your request. You do not make your request after I

have referred the Paper to the Committee to consider and report to the House. That is why I said it is belated. That is my response.

I am not saying that you should make the request before the Paper is laid. No, that is not proper. Immediately after it is laid, you make your request. The Minister is here, and as you said, these are routine audit reports. So you do not need much to see than what is stated there. But you have made your point.

Let us move on to the item numbered 9(c) by the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

Sorry. You want to draw his attention?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, equity, as you just said, does not favour the indolent. We must not come too late in the day. Since you have mentioned 9(c), fortunately, it is being done by the Minister himself. So if it pleases the Chair, I shall invoke Order 97(3) of the Standing Orders of this House and pray that the Minister acts in terms of Order 97(3).

Mr Speaker, the reason for this is that this lease agreement is a very important matter of national interest. Mr Speaker may recall that in the Eighth Parliament, this matter came up, and our friends who are in Government today had serious issues for all of us to deal with. So, if today, a thing like this has come back and they have gone to sign a new agreement, and my understanding is that the agreement has seen some amendments. Whatever it is, I would beg of the

Minister to give a short explanatory statement on this.

Mr Speaker, the mere fact that the Presentation of Papers is procedural does not mean that Members of this House cannot interrogate the matter before being referred. That is why, if we look at Order 97(5), it provides that “The Speaker may refer the Paper to the relevant Committee where appropriate.” “May refer”—What that tells us is that where in the wisdom of the Speaker, the Paper will require further Executive or Ministerial action, the Speaker may direct, if not persuaded, to say that the Minister should take this back and do the needful.

It is not automatic; else the provision would have read “shall”. The provision there is not “shall”. It does not provide a mandatory obligation on the Speaker. The Speaker has a discretion, and that discretion is to suggest that where it is imprudent for such a Paper to be referred, the Speaker will not.

So, Mr Speaker, if we read Order 97 (1), (3) and (5) together, it gives us a clear understanding of what the intendment of the drafters of this Regulation wanted us to do. The Paper must have sufficient copies distributed. Do we have sufficient copies distributed? If so, when a Member sees the need to request that the Minister makes a short explanatory statement which would cover the key areas of the subject matter, the rule says that it is mandatory.

5:20 p.m.

Then, upon that, Mr Speaker may then decide no, what you have done is not persuasive enough, please take it back and come again. There is no automaticity rule. There is nothing like it is automatic, so that once we present a Paper, it will be referred. That is not there.

Mr Speaker, this is a new matter. We have never dealt with a thing like this in this House. I would pray that the Hon Minister obliges with my prayer so that we can make progress.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minority Leader is clearly out of order. He is out of order because the Order is very clear, “a short explanatory statement”. It could be as short as one sentence. The Hon Minister can get up and say that as a result of new developments, it has become necessary to bring it back for Parliament to reconsider it, that is a short explanatory statement. Mr Speaker, Order 97(3) says:

“A short explanatory statement shall be made by the person presenting a Paper where requested by the House or a Member upon the presentation.”

Mr Speaker, what I thought he would be asking you to interpret is that at what stage would we say that the presentation has been made, at which point a Member can then get up and request for a short explanatory statement. I do not recall that the presentation has been done yet. It has not been done and he is already on his feet asking the Minister to make a short statement. He is not just asking the

Minister to make a short statement, he has proceeded to engage in a jurisprudence of interpreting the rules to the Speaker, explaining what the rule means. That is not important. The Minority Leader should wait, when the presentation is made, then his rights kick in, and he could ask for a short statement. The statement could be as short as a sentence, and then we move on. *[Hear! Hear!]*

The Speaker: Hon Members, the difficulty we have here is that some of us are suffering from confirmation bias. You have some ideas in your head. Whatever is said is of no essence. You do not hear it. You have to say something to confirm what you have in your head. *[Laughter]* We have gone through this process, and in fact, when the Hon Minority Chief Whip spoke and I explained it, he was nodding his head. The process is that when I call the Paper, it has to be laid.

When it is laid, a Member can get up and ask the person laying the Paper to make a short explanatory statement, before I call on the Committee to go and consider and report back to the House. We have gone through this step by step. We have gone to the next item, it has not yet been laid, and then the person who is to lay it is already being called upon to give a short explanatory statement. That is a case of confirmation bias. So, whatever we say, you do not listen. Please, do not let us be doing this in this House. We devoted time for a study of the Standing Orders of Parliament. We had a workshop, and now you come and we sit and we are not going to it, asking

for guidance, this and that—Ghanaians are watching and willing to see Business of the House. Yet, we are still learning our rules and procedures. That is not good enough. Please, let us proceed. Minister, lay the Paper. *[Hear! Hear!]*

By the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources—

Mining Lease Agreement Between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Barari DV Ghana Limited for the mining of Lithium and other minerals at Mankessim (42.63km²) in the Mfantseman District in the Central Region.

Referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I rise in terms of Standing Order 97(3) and pray the Minister provides an explanatory statement in respect of the Paper he just presented.

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah): Mr Speaker, as we know, the lease was indeed presented in the Eighth Parliament for ratification pursuant to Article 268(1) of the 1992 Constitution and section 5(4) of Minerals and Mining Act, 2006 (Act 703). It was not ratified before the House adjourned. Since then, the basis on which the agreement, especially the price of lithium, at the time of the negotiation was about US\$3,000—The price of lithium had fallen, the current price is about US\$630, making the project really at risk going

forward. The company appealed that if they were to go forward, certain key provisions must be looked at. Indeed, it was very clear in public knowledge that lithium prices had fallen. We took advantage of the high lithium prices of US\$3,000 at the time to, for example, move beyond the normal royalty of 5 per cent to 10 per cent and other provisions. Based on their request, three key areas have been looked at: the royalty rate adjustment, Value Added Tax (VAT) deferral on capital inputs, and source point transshipment facility feasibility. These three areas were new areas that had been factored, and that called for us to look at a new lease. The new lease has been negotiated, sent to Cabinet for approval, and we are here in Parliament to get ratification in accordance with Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution. I thank you.

5:30 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I accordingly refer the Mining Lease Agreement, which is referred to as 'new', to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report to the House.

Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor: Mr Speaker, you seem to have referred the agreement to the Committee—*[Interruption]* Mr Speaker, respectfully, I do not know whether the point I am about to make will find favour with you. When you read Standing Order 97(1) to (6), the totality of it, the combined effect of 97 (1) to (6), is to the effect that the Speaker has a discretion either to admit the laying and do the referral or not.

With the greatest of respect, I was in this House in the Eighth Parliament and I was called upon to give a similar explanatory statement for the laying of the Agreement for the exploitation of our lithium resources between these same two parties, the Government of Ghana and Barari DV Ghana Limited.

As the Speaker of the Eighth Parliament, you took particular interest in that Agreement.

Mr Speaker, you even on an occasion, invited me to your chamber and nudged me that we are required to carry the whole country with us, because of the importance of this Agreement and the mineral, lithium. I need not point out the controversy it generated in our country.

The invitation I was going to make of you is that, the application, and effort we made in the Eighth Parliament to lay an Agreement for the exploitation of the lithium resources between the same two parties, the Government of Ghana (GoG) and Barari DV Ghana Limited, which was rejected by this House—We could not lay it and it was not referred to a Committee.

Mr Speaker, the terms of explanatory statement made by the current Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, is not different from the terms of the explanatory statement I made in this House as the then Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. Therefore, I was going to pray you that this laying be overruled and this laying be rejected, by the combined effect of Order 97 (1) to (6). Because, I have the various

components the Minister has submitted to this House as being the fundamental terms of the Agreement between the same two parties. They are fundamentally not different. Therefore, same should apply as what applied to that Agreement in the Eighth Parliament, which fortunately had the same Speaker in the chair, which culminated in the rejection of the attempt to lay that Agreement.

Mr Speaker, I conclude by just asking a simple question and I want to believe that we will get into this matter in much more detail. The fundamental question, which the average Ghanaian will ask is that what has changed? What has changed? [*Uproar*]*—*What has changed in the then Agreement between GoG and Barari DV Ghana Limited and the terms of the Agreement between the GoG and Barari DV Ghana Limited in 2025.

Mr Speaker, I conclude by submitting that the position you took in the Eighth Parliament was for the good of Ghana. Lithium is a rare resource. Lithium is the mineral of the future, as the experts say. Lithium is the foundation of the current effort of green transition. Lithium is the bedrock that the world is attempting to use to fight climate change. So, when the Speaker insisted that Ghana should get the full benefit of the exploitation of our mineral resources, one could not disagree with you. But the question today is that what has changed in 2025? What has changed?

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please let us tolerate one another. Let us listen to one another in silence.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, first and foremost, Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor got his facts wrong. He was the Minister responsible for the Sector at that time. He brought the Agreement, laid it, and it was referred to the Committee. My recollection is that it never came back to the floor of the House. So, he cannot say that this House rejected it. This House did not reject the Agreement. The records of this House will bear me out. Yes, he brought it here, there was a lot of public interest in the matter, it was referred to the Committee, but it never got back to the Plenary for us to consider. So, it is not the case that the Agreement was rejected by Parliament.

If he recalls, the last few months of that Parliament was plagued with litigation, injunction after injunction—the great Osahen Afenyo-Markin, and the question of whether he was Minority or Majority Leader and whether his Side was a Majority or Minority, rendered this Parliament ineffective. This is because, we had injunctions, we were in court and never dealt with so many matters that were pending. It was not because the House considered it and rejected it. So, the life of the Parliament ended without the matter being considered. Normally, matters that come before us in the life of the Parliament is usually brought back to start afresh, if the life of that Parliament ends.

I believe it is in the spirit of this practice, that they have asked that we should start afresh the Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill. It is the same thing, that is why this is coming back.

Secondly, what has changed? Our sitting places have changed. [*Hear! Hear!*] Our sitting places have changed. More importantly, Ghanaians trust him with the management of the natural resources of this country. [*Hear! Hear!*]

They trust him, that is why they removed the New Patriotic Party (NPP) and voted for the National Democratic Congress (NDC). The NDC has proposed him as a Minister to handle it and he has brought it back to this House.

Mr Speaker, I do not think that we should split hairs because it has been referred to a Committee. They are Members of the Committee—Committee deliberations—I am encouraging Committee deliberations to be transparent. At the Committee, they can raise all the issues. Reports will be brought back to Plenary, we would debate and the key components that they are concerned about, they would have an opportunity to debate those key components. We would then take the vote and definitely, the Majority will speak.

So, I do not think there is any issue and I do not really think that he is complying with any of our Orders. Because there is nothing in our Orders that permits him to do what he has just done.

Mr Speaker, I think we should proceed.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader?

5:40 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, thank you.

My respected Colleague seated opposite to me, made references to me on certain matters. I feel obliged to respond and I thank you for giving me the space to respond.

Mr Speaker, I think first of all, he also got his facts wrong. If he argues, that that Agreement never came back to this House, he is wrong. At least I was a Majority Leader so I am able to put things in the right context.

Mr Speaker, with respect, when the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor as he then was, appeared before the Committee, Our Friends in the NDC held a press conference to register their opposition to the Agreement in its entirety. So, it is a reason he asked what has changed.

Now, Mr Speaker, the Hon Leader of Government Business should accord me that respect I always give him. I am always quiet whenever he is speaking because I know that I have the content in me, so I do not need to rush. Mr Speaker, if one prepares to come into this Chamber, he will fear no evil. Even if I am given one minute, I will speak on the matter that I prepared for, so he should

allow me, so that the two of us can show a good example to our followers.

Mr Speaker, I was the Leader of Government Business, and the attempt to lay the Paper— I am happy the then Deputy Minority Leader, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah is right here in this Chamber—he and his Colleagues denied us the opportunity to lay this Paper, saying that they would not allow. In fact, Mr Speaker, Hon Kwame Agbodza, was right here and I was here begging him. To quote him “There will be chaos in this Chamber.”; I have the *Hansard*. Those were his words, that there will be chaos if we attempt to lay it. Today they have brought this agreement in their own words. They said the prices have gone down.

Mr Speaker, this agreement in its current state is worse than before. Royalties have lowered. If the Majority Leader’s only response is that the change is because they are now in Majority, then where is the principle? If yesterday they told the people of Ghana that a particular agreement in its form and shape was not good for the country, but today they say that the mere fact that they are in Majority, they have the numbers, so they bring the same agreement in its worst situation, then because they have super Majority, they pass it.

Mr Speaker, all of a sudden, our Hon Friends on the opposite Side have forgotten their own principle requiring pre-laying. Mr Speaker, in the 8th Parliament our Hon Friends introduced a new system of practise called pre-laying, that if there is no pre-laying, we cannot

proceed. They emphasised that important documents must be pre-laid. Pre-laying to them meant that Leadership must have the matter deliberated extensively for a consensus to be built.

Mr Speaker may recall that on the matters of tax waiver, they argued strongly that we should do a pre-laying and discuss it before we even lay it; that is what they did. But you know, I have told them, and I will repeat that, that thing called posterity—today, the Rules are being interpreted, Hon Ayariga is introducing new jurisprudence, I will take them. I will not be pained at all or be emotional about it. Whenever I am arrested, I will say “yes sir”, but they will be hunted by their own deeds. They told the people of Ghana that the Lithium agreement was bad, but it is the same agreement.

They have not changed a word. They have brought the same agreement that they said was bad. *Ɔkɔto deɛ ne bo dwɛ*. When it was under the Nana Akufo-Addo Government they said the agreement was bad. Today, even when the royalties have been lowered, they are bringing it. When prices have gone down, they are now bringing it claiming that they have a super Majority, so they will use their numbers to pass it. We want to be guided by principle, and remind our Hon Colleagues that it is only fair to be consistent and remain firm on a matter that they believe strongly is good or wrong.

Mr Speaker, today, if because the Majority is in power, they have found it

convenient to reintroduce the very agreement they rejected—

The Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, please.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I am sorry. Mr Speaker, let us up our game.

The Speaker: Please, Hon Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker. I will not disrespect you. If you want me to resume my seat, I will.

The Speaker: You were in full flight.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I will always yield to you.

The Speaker: Hon Members, sometimes you are in a haste to debate matters. In fact, I am fully aware of what happened in the last Parliament and I can assure you that I am as equally committed to this whole process and agreement as I was in the last Parliament. This is because it deals with the minerals of this country, particularly a very important mineral which has a future—Lithium. I had civil society leaders and experts in the subject matter giving me copious brief on the lease agreement. That was why I expressed my views about Parliament taking a critical look at that lease agreement. So, the agreement was not rejected, but we were trying to put a process in place for Parliament to critically examine it and make sure that the right thing is done. That was what happened.

But please, our Rules are very clear. You read Order 97 (1) which says:

“Whenever sufficient copies of a Paper have been received in the Office of the Clerk for distribution to Members, notice of the presentation of that Paper may be placed on the Order Paper and when the Speaker announces “Presentation of Papers,” the person laying the Paper shall rise and bow to the Chair and the Clerk shall read the title of the Paper and the Paper shall be considered to have been laid on the Table.”

That is the process. But you know, before we get to this stage, that Paper would have been admitted by the Speaker. That Paper would have gone through the Clerk and to the Business Committee. The Business Committee would have scheduled it in the Business Statement, then it will find space in the *Order Paper*. That is the process they go through before it is laid.

So, when the Speaker really calls for the Paper to be laid, it is automatic that the Member is called upon to bow, the Clerk is called upon to read, then what happens? The Paper shall be considered to have been laid on the Table. Laying on the Table means the table in front here, the Clerks-at-the-Table. What happens is that after the bowing, the title of the copy that is there is read by the officers at the Table and it is placed there; that is the process.

Now, I refer it to the relevant Committee. I cannot, after it has been

laid, exercise a discretion to say no. I do not have that discretion; that is not the Rule.

5:50 p.m.

It is after the Report is submitted by the Committee; the Committee would consider it. The Committee may come to say that the Motion or Resolution should not be approved or adopted and the House would take the decision. The Speaker does not come in here. Please, I do not recall that lease agreement being rejected by the House. I know there was insistence that there should be pre-laying, consideration, and all those things. But it was actually not presented and rejected by the House. That was not done.

So, now that it is being brought up, we are referring to the relevant Committee. Every Member is allowed to visit and attend the Committee's meetings, make contributions, and come to the Floor when the Report is presented. You can disagree or agree with the Committee but at the end of the day, we make the decision. That is it.

But I am very passionate about the agreements we sign concerning minerals in this country. The brief that I have, I would be very critical of whatever lease agreement comes here. My critique would be to guide the House; nothing but that. Because I do not make the decision. I would critique it to guide the House. And that is all.

So please, you do not have anything to fear. I still have all the materials that

were given to me by people who have been in the industry for donkey years. So do not worry. We would present all, and the decision would be taken. People in government are aware that when they take the wrong decision, the effect on the Government is usually very telling when the people disagree with it. So, I am sure that after changing positions, the Right or the Left Side of the Speaker, many times now, you all understand the situation. Let us always agree that it is the national interest that prevails, not a party's interest.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the ruling. Except to correct some misrepresentation made by the Minority Leader. He said that this Agreement is one in which the royalties have been reduced. And he has put that out. That is not true.

Mr Speaker, the royalties have not been reduced. The royalties have been pegged to the price of lithium. So, when lithium prices go up, royalties would also go up. When lithium prices come down, royalties would also come down. So, I —

The Speaker: Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Yes.

The Speaker: Please, we would get there. The Report would come to the House, and we would debate it.

Hon Member, hold your cool. Let them bring the Report. We would debate it. That is why I am here to protect you.

So do not worry, I would protect you as the Minority. I would never allow them to bully you. [*Uproar*]

Please, let us hold on. Let the Committee consider and report to the House. Hon Members, let us take the item numbered 9(d) (i), (ii), and (iii) by the Chairman of the Committee.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Chairman of the Committee is not immediately available so with your indulgence, I am requesting that you allow the Vice-Chairman to lay the Report.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose* —

The Speaker: Are you on the issue he has raised? Let us complete what he just said. He wants the Vice Chairman to lay this Report.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, before that laying, I tried to, with respect, catch your attention —

The Speaker: I would come back to you. Let us finish with that one.

PAPERS

By the Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

- (i) Report of the Finance Committee on the Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025.

- (ii) Report of the Finance Committee on the 2024 Annual Report on the Petroleum Funds.

- (iii) Report of the Finance Committee on the 2024 Annual Public Debt Report.

Referred to the Finance Committee.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, if you may indulge me, early on, I tried to catch your attention on the referral on the Mining Lease Agreement. I humbly want to suggest that we add— It is on mining, and Mr Speaker, in this country, we all witness the devastation on the environment in terms of mining, and its effects on water bodies. I wish we could add at least the Leadership of the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology, because the referral was done to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources. If we could rope in just the Leadership of the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology. I think it would not be out of place.

Mr Speaker, I humbly suggest.

The Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think that the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is now acting as Minister for Environment, Science and Technology. And so, it would be good that these matters were also considered at that level.

So, let us add the Leadership of the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology, just to give an indication

that we are taking the issues of the environment in mining very seriously as a House. So, we want the Leadership to be part of it to scrutinise the environmental issues so that we do not create problems.

So, Mr Speaker, I agree with him. We can add the Leadership of the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Leadership of the Committee of Environment, Science and Technology should join the Committee on Lands and Forestry to consider the referral and report to the House. I so direct.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Committee is Lands and Natural Resources, not Lands and Forestry.

The Speaker: Have we changed the title?

Alhaji Collins Dauda: Mr Speaker, your Committee is now Lands and Natural Resources.

The Speaker: Sorry, Hon Members, correction to the title; not Lands and Forestry as before. It is now Lands and Natural Resources. That is what has changed. Sometimes, it is interesting to get humour in this matter. Should we proceed to Questions now?

[Referred to the Finance Committee and Leadership of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources.]

Mr Ayariga: Yes, Mr Speaker, we can take Questions now.

6:00 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, item numbered 7, we have Questions. The first Question, 211, stands in the name of Prof Kingsley Nyarko, the Member of Parliament for Kwadaso.

Hon Member, you may ask your Question now.

Leaders, you do not want us to proceed?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No, Mr Speaker, we wish to proceed. I was just trying to draw the attention of the Leader of the House.

We had earlier agreed that because we have the presentation of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, 2026 on Thursday, we would want to have a prior discussion at the Committee of the Whole, and the Hon Minister for Finance has been noticed. So, I wish to find out from the Hon Majority Leader if we have a confirmation of the meeting of the Committee of the Whole.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I was waiting so that when you decide that you have had enough for the day and your Deputy takes over, I will then request for the meeting of the Committee of the Whole. I cannot request for a meeting of

the Committee of the Whole while you are in the Chair.

The Speaker: Hon Members, clearly you are interested in the First Deputy Speaker taking over the Chair—*[Laughter]*—so I will yield to the First Deputy Speaker to take the Chair. But rest assured that while you are having the meeting of the Committee of the Whole, I will be present. *[Laughter]*

Let us continue with your Questions before he comes. He has not taken over yet, or you want us to constitute into the Committee of the Whole now? — **[Some Hon Members:** Yes, yes] — But Hon Members, are you asking for a meeting of the Committee of the Whole or a Closed Sitting, because Committee of the Whole is different from Closed Sitting.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will have a Closed Sitting.

The Speaker: Closed Sitting?

Mr Ayariga: Yes, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the House is to go into Closed Sitting now, therefore, I will have to call on the Marshal's Department to clear the gallery so that only Members will be on the floor.

6:05 p.m. — *[Sitting suspended.]*

7.55 p.m. — *[Sitting resumed.]*

MOTION

Petroleum Agreement between GoG, GNPC, GNPC Explorco and Tristar for the Exploration, Development and Production Operations in Ghana Western Basin Block I

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Energy on the Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco) and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1 (GH_WB_01).

Mr Speaker, I present the Committee's Report and request the Office of Chamber Reporting to capture the entire Report as being read.

Introduction

The Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco), and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration,

development, and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 01 (GH_WB_01) was laid in Parliament by the Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition on 22nd October, 2025 in accordance with Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution.

The First Deputy Speaker, pursuant to Order 252 of the Standing Orders, subsequently referred the Petroleum Agreement to the Committee on Energy for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition, the Hon Deputy Minister and other officials of the Ministry to consider the Petroleum Agreement. Officials of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), Explorco and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited were in attendance to assist in the deliberations.

The Committee expresses its profound gratitude to the Hon Minister and the Deputy Minister, officials of the Ministry, officials of GNPC, GNPC Explorco, and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited for their assistance during the deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;
- iii. The Petroleum Commission Act, 2011 (Act 821);
- iv. The Income Tax Act, 2015 (Act 896);
- v. The Environmental Protection Act, 2025 (Act 1124);
- vi. The Environmental Assessment Regulations, 1999 (L.I 1652);
- vii. The Petroleum (Exploration and Production) Act, 2016 (Act 919);
- viii. The Ghana National Petroleum Corporation Law 1983;
- ix. The Ghana Model Petroleum Agreement;
- x. Local Content and Local Participation Regulations L.I 2221;
- xi. The Petroleum Exploration and Production (Measurement) Regulations, 2016 (L.I. 2246);
- xii. The Petroleum Exploration and Production (Data Management) Regulations, 2017 (L.I 2257);
- xiii. The Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) Act 2015, Act 893; and
- xiv. The Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green

Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco), and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development, and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 01 (GH_WB_01).

Background Information

The Ghana Western Basin Block 01 (Block GH_WB_01) is located in the shallow waters of the prolific Tano Basin. The Tano Basin plays host to many oil and gas projects and discoveries. Foremost among them are the Greater Jubilee Field, the TEN Field and the Sankofa Gye Nyame field, which are in deeper waters. The GH-WB-01 Block is located north of these major producing fields.

During Ghana's First Oil and Gas licensing round (refer to Ghana Gazette No.142 dated 1st November, 2018), Block GH-WB-01 was reserved for the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) by the Minister for Energy pursuant to Section 7(9) of the Petroleum (Exploration and Production Act, 2016 (Act 919). Based on this, GNPC, on 17th January, 2020, applied for Ministerial Authorisation to undertake petroleum activities in the block, which was granted on 2nd July, 2020.

The Authorisation was, however, not submitted to Parliament for ratification because of issues about the Corporation's ability to fund the

petroleum activities alone. The Ministry, therefore, directed the GNPC to acquire further data and undertake preliminary studies on the block and subsequently granted it a three (3) year reconnaissance license to acquire 3D seismic data over the block. The Corporation was still mobilising to acquire the data when the reconnaissance licence expired in June 2024.

Following consultations with the Minister, the Corporation applied for exploration and production rights over the block using its subsidiary, Explorco as the contractor on 29th April, 2024 and through a letter dated 3rd July, 2024, submitted an amended application for the same block to the Ministry, with Tristar as a partner after considering other potential partners.

The terms negotiated by the Corporation and proposed by the applicants for inclusion in the Agreement were largely satisfactory, leaving very few issues for negotiations. Areas that fell short of expectation, including the royalty proposed, were improved upon and accepted by the applicants.

It is worthy of note that with insights gathered over the years in relation to petroleum exploration, the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition has resolved to strategically position the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) and GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco) to carry out exploration activities for the maximum benefit of Ghana. Currently, GNPC is positioned to

explore in shallow waters. Furthermore, GNPC, having sunk significant amount of funds in other endeavours would, in the interim, require partnership with other parties for financial support. For this reason, GNPC went into partnership with Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited to contribute funding for the activities under this Petroleum Agreement.

The benefits of undertaking the petroleum activities with a third party are that the risks and costs of the project will be shared and the Corporation still gets to develop its technical and financial capabilities. Given that the block is reserved for GNPC, its subsidiary, Explorco, will have a critical role as a joint operator of the block, distinct from other blocks where Explorco only has financial non-operating interests. This process of reservation of a block for GNPC responds to the policy objective of developing the national oil company to be financially and operationally independent particularly in this era of energy transition. A financially independent GNPC will reduce the financial burden on Government.

Justification

The exploration and development of Ghana's oil and gas resources remain a central priority of Government policy. This strategic focus reflects the recognition that successful commercial discoveries and production will substantially boost national revenue, strengthen energy security, and advance socio-economic development. Increased availability of domestic crude oil will

reduce dependence on imported petroleum products, while the development of natural gas resources will provide a reliable and cost-effective source of fuel for power generation, industrial processing, and other economic activities.

Furthermore, Government is firmly committed to ensuring that revenues derived from petroleum resources are managed transparently, accountably, and sustainably for the collective benefit of both present and future generations. This approach aligns with Ghana's overarching objective of leveraging its natural resource wealth to promote inclusive growth and long-term national development.

The Petroleum Agreement covering Block GH_WB_01 therefore represents a critical step toward realising these national objectives. The Agreement establishes the legal and operational framework for the exploration, appraisal, development, and eventual production of petroleum resources within the designated block. Its implementation is expected to attract significant investment into the upstream petroleum sector, create employment opportunities, enhance local technical capacity, and generate substantial fiscal returns to the state.

More importantly, the Agreement was negotiated in strict compliance with the established regulatory and policy framework governing Ghana's petroleum sector. This includes adherence to the Model Petroleum Agreement, which serves as the guiding

template to ensure consistency, fairness and alignment with national interests. It also conforms to the provisions of the Petroleum (Exploration and Production) Act, 2016 (Act 919); the Petroleum Commission Act, 2011 (Act 821); and the Local Content and Local Participation Regulations, 2013 (L.I. 2204), as amended. Collectively, these legal instruments ensure that petroleum operations are conducted responsibly, with a strong emphasis on maximising local value addition, employment, and technology transfer.

8:00 p.m.

In addition, the Agreement is consistent with the Income Tax Act, 2015 (Act 896) and other applicable fiscal laws, guaranteeing equitable financial benefits to the State. The negotiation process was anchored on the principles of transparency, national interest, and sustainable development, making the Petroleum Agreement for Block GH_WB_01 both economically sound and socially beneficial.

The contractor's participating interest as at the effective date shall be divided as follows:

Company	Exploration	Development	Production
Tristar	76.5 per cent	65 per cent	65 per cent
Explorco	17.6 per cent	15 per cent	15 per cent
Indigenous Ghanaian Company	5.9 per cent	5 per cent	5 per cent

Per Article 15.2 of the Petroleum Agreement, as of the effective date, contractor shall pay an annual acreage fee over the Contract Area, in accordance with Section 86 of the Petroleum Act within sixty (60) days of from the date of ratification of this Agreement. Thereafter, and during the term of this

Agreement, contractor shall pay an annual acreage fee per kilometre of the portion of the contract area remaining at the beginning of each contract year, pursuant to Regulation 5(1)(b) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Regulations, 2019 (L.I. 2381).

Phase of Exploration	Acreage Fee Per Annum
Initial Exploration Period	US\$150 per sq. km.
First Extension Period	US\$300 per sq. km.
Second Extension Period	US\$300 per sq. km.
Development & Production Area	US\$600 per sq. km.

Observations

Legal and Procedural Context

The Committee observed that the Petroleum Agreement entered into among the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), Explorco, and Tristar is governed by the provisions of the Petroleum (Exploration and Production) Act, 2016 (Act 919), the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815), and Article 268(1) of the 1992 Constitution. In accordance with these legal provisions, all petroleum agreements executed by the state or its agencies require Parliamentary ratification to become effective and binding.

The Committee further noted that under Ghana's First Oil and Gas Licensing Round, Block GH-WB-01 was reserved for direct negotiation with the Corporation by the Minister for Energy, in line with section 7(9) of Act 919. Authorisation for GNPC to

undertake petroleum activities in the Block was granted on 2nd July, 2020. However, the Authorisation was not presented to Parliament for ratification at the time, due to concerns regarding the Corporation's financial capacity to independently undertake the petroleum operations.

Shareholding and Participating Interest

The Committee examined the ownership structure and observed that during the exploration phase, Tristar holds 76.5 per cent, Explorco holds 17.6 per cent, and the State (through GNPC) holds 5.9 per cent as carried interest.

Upon discovery of oil, the carried interest of the state automatically increases to 15 per cent, with corresponding reductions in the shares of the other parties.

It was explained by Management of GNPC that this arrangement follows the

standard petroleum fiscal framework, under which the interest of the state is carried by GNPC until commercial discovery is made.

The Committee found this structure to be consistent with industry practice, as it enables the state to benefit from production revenues without bearing exploration risks. However, Members emphasised that future negotiations should aim to maximise Ghana's equity participation while maintaining a balance that keeps the investment environment attractive to prospective partners.

Minimal Risk Associated with Exploration in the Western Basin

The Committee was informed that the exploration activities in the Western Basin present minimal operational risk, primarily because the block falls within a shallow water zone. According to the technical briefings provided, shallow water drilling is generally less complex and less capital-intensive compared to deep water operations, thereby reducing both financial exposure and environmental risk.

Indigenous Participation and Local Content

The Committee noted that the Agreement provides for a 5 per cent participation interest to be reserved for an indigenous Ghanaian company, in accordance with the Petroleum (Local Content and Local Participation) Regulations, 2013 (L.I.2204).

At the time of the meeting, however, the Ministry had confirmed the specific local company. It was indicated that ROC Africa had been proposed, pending verification and Ministerial approval.

Members stressed the need for transparency and fairness in the selection of the indigenous partner to ensure that the objective of empowering Ghanaian businesses in the oil and gas value chain is realised.

The Committee emphasised that the selection process should be competitive, merit-based and consistent with local content regulations.

Conclusion

The Committee has critically examined the Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco), and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development, and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 01 (GH_WB_01) and reports that the Agreement aligns with relevant legislations on the subject and does not violate the letter and spirit of the 1992 Constitution.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this Report and approve the Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of

Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco), and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development, and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 01 (GH_WB_01) in accordance with Article 268 of the 1992 Constitution.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved, any seconder?

Mr George Kwame Aboagye (NPP—Asene/Manso/Akroso): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion moved by the Chairman. This agreement is between the Government of the Republic of Ghana, represented by GNPC, Explorco, and Tristar Upstream Limited.

Mr Speaker, this agreement is necessary for this House to support and ratify because the crude oil production in Ghana has been dwindling for some time now, and this agreement is one of the most progressive agreements I have seen so far. Why do I say so? GNPC, on its part, has a current interest of 10 per cent royalties and 35 per cent income tax. Explorco is getting 17.6 per cent at the exploration level and 15 per cent at the development and production level, with five per cent for an indigenous Ghanaian company, which makes this agreement a progressive one.

Mr Speaker, at the Committee level, I raised a lot of issues, especially on the

environment, because this oil production is in shallow waters. GNPC assured us that a proper environmental impact assessment will be done.

I also raised a very big concern on gas flaring, and the assurance given by GNPC is that they will do their part in minimising it, and asked this august House to also try as much as possible to ensure that we do the needful, especially to absorb the number of gas that are being produced on all our platforms because we all know the impact on climate change with gas flaring.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I urge this hon House to support this ratification between the Government of Ghana, represented by GNPC, Explorco, and Tristar Upstream Limited.

Thank you.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (NDC—Evalue-Ajomoro-Gwira): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to comment on the Motion before us, and to speak in support of it.

Mr Speaker, we are at a stage where, as a country, we need to prioritise energy security, and I am very happy that this exploration would help in that regard. Because currently we are doing much to ensure that our energy mix—we look at gas, because of our drive to ensure that we limit the burning of fossil fuel, which

in the end contributes to the climate issues.

Looking at the Report, I am very happy that an indigenous Ghanaian company is holding about 5 per cent of it. We are talking about technological transfer, where, as Ghanaians, we will be able to position ourselves well when it comes to—and also, after development, we know 50 per cent will come to us. I believe at this point in time, this is a good deal, and it could not have come at a better moment than now.

So, I want to support it, and I pray that this House also endorses it. I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kwabena Darko-Mensah.

8:05 p.m.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP—Takoradi): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to support Motion numbered 13, as stated in the Order Paper.

Mr Speaker, I take a cue from the Ranking Member on the need to support this Motion in particular. I am particular about the issue of local content because I believe that when Ghanaians get the opportunity, it is important that we support them to participate. Unfortunately, this Report does not give us the beneficial owners of ROC, which is the local company we are expecting to partner with on this project.

Mr Speaker, oftentimes, we have had the opportunity of selecting local content

people or local participants, but they are not able to deliver. I believe that this selection would ensure that, for the first time, it will move from exploration all the way to production, and Ghanaian companies can really raise the money to participate and get the benefits, so the benefits can also stay in this country.

Mr Speaker, these days, we know that not until the time we had this Russia-Ukraine war, a lot of financial institutions were withdrawing from investing in hydrocarbons because they thought that they had an environmental impact.

Today, people are investing, looking at Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG) issues. And I believe that if we take the Western Region in particular—Recently, people said we have been producing oil for a very long time, and they do not seem to see the effects on the daily lives of the people in the region.

Mr Speaker, I believe that this is one area we need to ensure that, as part of the exploration, as part of the production methods that we bring on board, local communities will see the real prosperity that they were told that oil would bring to this country. Yes, oil has been able to do so much for us. Free Senior High School and a lot of infrastructure has been funded by oil.

But, I believe that it is time that we invest in the local businesses, so that local communities can generate wealth and the wealth can be seen around and among the people within the areas of oil and gas production.

Mr Speaker, we know that apart from this one, which is in the shallow waters very soon We are looking at the Voltaian basin which will actually be on the land. If we do not prepare well with the offshore issues, I believe that we get onshore we may have major difficulties we might not even be able to solve like what has happened in Nigeria over some time. I believe that we need not bring the curse onto Ghana. We need to make sure that we get the best out of it as the way people have gotten it in Calgary and other parts of the world, the North Sea and the rest.

Mr Speaker, I believe that, if you look at the progressive nature of the tax system that has been aligned and the carried interest arrangement that has been put in place, I believe that all of us need to support this and let us take a good shot at it. I believe that when the exploration is completed and production itself starts, we can add to our stocks and Ghana can benefit more from the oil and gas industry as we have it. With these few words, I stand to support it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you have the floor.

Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (NDC — Yilo Krobo): I rise to support the motion moved by the Chairman. The Committee examined the ownership structure and observed that during the exploration phase, Tristar holds 76.5 per cent, Exploco holds 17.6 per cent and the State through GNPC holds 5.9 per cent as carried interest. Upon discovery of oil, the carried interest of the State's automatically increases to 15 per cent

with corresponding reductions in the shares of the other parties. Mr Speaker, the Committee found that this structure is consistent with industry practice and it enables the State to benefit from production revenues without bearing exploration risk. However, Members emphasised that future negotiations should aim to maximise Ghana's equity participation while maintaining a balance that keeps the investment environment attractive to foreign investors. I therefore urge the house to adopt this Report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, you have the floor. From there, I will come to Leadership.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Mr Speaker, I rise to comment on the Reports before this House concerning the Petroleum Agreement between Government of the Republic of Ghana, GNPC, Explorco and Tristar the exploration development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1. I have gone through the document, and I must say that over the years, Ghana has entered into a couple of Petroleum Agreements and Ghana over time has also learnt how to ensure that at the end of the day the interest of the Ghanaian people is protected.

One of the key areas Ghanaians are interested in when it comes to Petroleum Agreements are in the areas of royalty payments, in the areas of protecting the Ghanaian interest in the area of taxation amongst others. If you go with me to page 8 of the Report, paragraph 5.5, it states that the agreement is consistent

with the Income Tax Act 2015 (Act 896), and other applicable fiscal laws guaranteeing equitable financial benefits to the State.

I believe that with the current Income tax of about 35 per cent and Corporate tax of 35 per cent, as in the Income Tax Act as well as the royalty payments, I am very happy that if this agreement as approved by this House will go a long way of protecting Ghanaian interest even after the exploration of oil. Mr Speaker, without much ado I want to call on Colleagues of this House to support this agreement so that Government of Ghana becomes the overall beneficiary. I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader

8:15 p.m.

Osahen Alexander Afenyo-Markin (NPP — Effutu): If you pay due regard to page 6 of the 13 page Report, particularly paragraph 4.4, I quote: “It is worthy of note that with insight gathered over the years in relation to petroleum exploration the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition has resolved to strategically position the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation and the GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited, Exploco, to carry out exploration activities for the maximum benefit of Ghana. Currently Ghana is positioned to explore in shallow waters furthermore GNPC haven sunk significant amount of fund in other endeavours will in the interim require partnership with other parties for

financial support.” Mr Speaker, this is a very profound statement. How much has GNPC sunk in other endeavours. If you look at page 9, figures have been provided. Data is supported, but national Assembly made up of the people's representatives to be told of certain expenditures, it is important that we know how much, for what period and for what particular purpose?

Mr Speaker, the absence of this important information creates a challenge for me and for this House. This is a house of records, everything would be referred to tomorrow. We cannot talk about GNPC making commitments and spending monies without disclosures. This is going into public records. I would plead, if you would oblige me and if Hon Chairman of the Committee will oblige me that we place this on ice temporary. We have done this before where we make amendment to the Report, or if it is immediately available and supported with the necessary data and documentation, same could be brought for us to consider. But, to consider the report in its present form and shape will be a problem because this is what the Report is saying that there have been some expenditures. Where is that expenditure, how much and for what purpose? Was there value for money *et cetera*?

Mr Speaker, so, I hold the view, Mr Speaker, that the disclosure in paragraph 4.4 is a critical disclosure in the report. We cannot wish it away. All the good things that have been said, and I have read them, the advantages we stand to gain, and I heard my respected

Colleague, the Hon Ranking Member, and then my own senior colleague, Member of Parliament (MP) for Takoradi, Hon Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah. He is well-versed on these issues. We followed his exploits when we were not in this Chamber. They are Seniors. I have heard his argument and I have nothing to say against that.

But there is one good reason why Committee reports come into the Plenary for us to also further interrogate; as our elders say, *nyansa nni baako foɔ tirimu*. To wit, wisdom does not reside in one person. It is the collective that brings idea so that that which is not perfect is made perfect. So, Mr Speaker, I shall resume my seat without more to say, having drawn the House's attention to this important information that is missing, of which, in my view, makes the report incomplete. Therefore, I pray that the Hon Minister and my Hon Colleague, the Chairman, would confer with the Ranking Member and produce documentation to support this.

Mr Speaker, I said without more, but just to add that I know the exploits of the Hon Minister who was the Ranking Member when he was on the other Side. We know what he stood for. He would always insist on the right thing being done, and he knows that this thing that we are doing is to support him. It helps his own Ministry. I will not be able to make reference to his records in the *Hansard*, but for his eight years as Ranking Member on the Committee on Energy, he really took issues and helped shape the policy direction in this area that we are discussing today. So, Mr Speaker,

let him make those documentations available on the purpose, how much, what period, and whether or not there has been value for money. Mr Speaker, I resume my seat, having made my point. Thank you so much for the sufficient space granted.

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan (NDC — Cape Coast South): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I rise in support of this agreement. The beauty of this agreement is that this is something that I believe started before the new Government came in, and it is being continued by this current Administration. Government is a continuous concern, and things that are done that will benefit the country should definitely be continued

I would like to thank those who have worked on this, including the current administration, in bringing, what I believe will be a fruitful conclusion. We can actually see the benefits that this agreement will have for this country to the extent that 15 per cent will actually come to the Government of Ghana eventually. I was quite surprised when the Hon Minority Leader was talking. He said something about GNPC.

But my understanding is that the work plan of GNPC comes to this House, together with all the expenditures. So, I am not quite sure. I am just—
[Interruption] Can the Hon Minority Leader relax? I do not know where that is coming from, because as I said, if that is happening, then that is quite dangerous. When a work plan comes here and expenditure patterns also end up

here before and after, then it is difficult to find out where some money will be spent without anyone knowing where that has gone.

But I just want to commend those who have worked on this, and that we are in the end going to have the Ghana Western Basin Block developed, and they will be able to get some production out of it for the benefit of this country. Mr Speaker, with that, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, once the Hon Minister is here, I am minded to give him some two minutes.

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Let me thank everybody for their commentary except to set just two issues straight.

First of all, Mr Speaker, this agreement pre-dates me. I did not negotiate this agreement. All I am doing is presenting an agreement I inherited to Parliament in accordance to law and the Constitution.

Secondly, the Hon Minority leader talks about paragraph 4.4, and he places emphasis on this statement “Furthermore, GNPC, having sunk significant amounts of funds in other endeavours ...”, so it is talking about other expenditure, not this very field. So, firstly, my point is that this very agreement and other expenditures are not the same. Secondly, every expenditure of GNPC, even before they spend, comes to

this House. Not even GH¢1 can be spent by the national oil company until this House approves their work programme. After their work programme, whenever the year ends, those expenditures are submitted to this House again for scrutiny.

So, when we say having spent on other endeavours over the years, and a petroleum agreement is presented, and I am told that what is before Parliament, which is public record, in terms of pre-approval and post-approval, I should go and submit it again before this agreement is passed, I would want to appeal to the Hon Minority Leader. Please, I beg him. I know he wants transparency, and I support that, but in these very circumstances I do not see how the two co-mingle.

Even the information he is asking for, is readily available here, because every year, like I said, the Hon Ranking Member is here, the work programme, which carries all the estimates, and what they want to do, and the appropriation is approved here. Then at the end of the year, in line with this transparency, all the expenditures are submitted to this House again. Mr Speaker, I would want to thank everybody, and appeal to the House to approve this agreement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I will give you the floor, and urge on you, that in view of the time, it should be brief.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I will be very brief. We are dealing with language. This report was

not authored by me. It is a report authored by our Committee, and being brought to us. For the avoidance of doubts, and at the risk of being repetitive, the Hon Minister should hear the language one more time. It says “Furthermore, GNPC, having sunk significant amount of funds in other endeavours”. If he invokes the generality rule on “other endeavours”, that is where the challenge is.

8:25 p.m.

You cannot say that the mere fact that GNPC brings its annual work programme for this house to approve. Therefore, there should be that presumption of regularity that indeed what you are referring to is what is already before the house. No!

Mr Speaker, if that is a path the Hon Minister is going, I am afraid we may not be able to lend support to this. Yes. I am not litigating this, but this is a legitimate concern. Perhaps the Minister may want to say something else. I am happy he says that my desire for transparency is appreciated. Thank you for that. But what I am asking is not about demanding something without reason. It is also inappropriate for my respected Colleague, the Minister, to say that he came to meet; government is a continuum. And I am sure because he is satisfied that what was done prior to his assumption of office was the right thing.

This part of the report is talking about significant funds sunk. That is the word, it is not mine. So, what I am asking is what other endeavours is he referring to? Can you specify the other endeavours?

Mr Speaker, we are talking about particulars. You may say that you can furnish us at a later date. I do not mind. But I want public records to capture —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you promised me.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well, Mr Speaker. I am landing. I want public records to capture these concerns. And I need your commitment that these other endeavours, their specifics would be provided because it is in your domain. Maybe the Committee even has a document, but can produce it at a later date. Mr Speaker, this House, at least with that assurance, can support. So maybe let us give the Minister the chance.

Mr Speaker, we cannot, without assurance, presume that because we approved the annual work programme of GNPC, the Report saying that other endeavours we should accept other endeavours. What are those endeavours? But if he assures us that with respect, he would be able to provide the details of those other things that expenditures were made, of which reference is being made as other endeavours, that is fine. They would be fine with me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Do not go beyond two minutes.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Let me assure the Minority Leader that I take his cue, and that I would provide the information. I am happy that he says that he would

support it if I provide that assurance. I would provide that assurance.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, this is Leadership. I appreciate that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the essence of our work is to get things done right. And I am saying for public records, that that assurance, that those further and better particulars would be provided, it is leadership, and I appreciate that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It has gone into the records.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am saying that is Leadership, and I take your word for that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Just allay your fears.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, without more, I support it then.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, item numbered 14.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, before we go into other matters, it is 8:31 p.m. or 8: 32 p.m. if I am seeing the clock

rightly. The murmuring from the Backbench is that the Minister for Energy and Green Transition comes in and goes out. That is the murmuring.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I believe the Minister understood your language. So, item numbered 14, in no time, it would be done.

RESOLUTION

Petroleum Agreement between GoG, GNPC, GNPC Explorco and Tristar for the Exploration, Development and Production Operations in Ghana Western Basin Block I

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

WHEREAS

By the provisions of Article 268 (1) of the Constitution, any transaction, contract or undertaking involving the grant of a right or concession by or on behalf of any person or body of persons howsoever described, for the exploitation of any mineral, water or other natural resource of Ghana made or entered into after the coming into force of the Constitution is made subject to ratification by Parliament;

In pursuance of the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution, the Government of Ghana has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Energy and Green Transition the Petroleum

Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco) and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1 (GH_WB_01)..

Now therefore, this House in accordance with the said Article 268 (1) of the Constitution hereby resolve to ratify the said Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition), Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Company Limited (Explorco) and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1 (GH_WB_01).

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has been moved and seconded. It is for the consideration of the House. Hon Members, this is a consequential Resolution.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Deputy Majority Leader, we are in your hands.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, there are a few Questions that name of the Minister, and I think he wants to proceed by answering the Questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have a problem with the Minister responding to the Questions, but considering the time, if you can regulate it. Because if we elect to say we should postpone it, we have already postponed other Questions for today, but he has about nine or 10 Questions.

So, if you can regulate the supplementary questions so that we can speed up.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do we give room to one follow-up question and limits it to the questioner?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes.

Mr Speaker, the questioner should exercise his right within the Orders but any other supplementary question should just be one from one person and nothing more.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, when we do this — the Minister is my former friend. Sometimes, he is here for

long. You know his Brother is my Friend, but he is my former Friend, so when we are doing some of this, it is not because of him, it is because his Brother is here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: As for me, they are both my Friends.

Item 7; Question time. Question numbered 211 stands in the name of Prof Kingsley Nyarko. Subject to the terms agreed upon, you have the floor.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Which the terms are?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You have listened to the Deputy Whip.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I did not hear what he said.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, proceed

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

Reforms to Address Structural Inefficiencies at ECG

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP—Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the specific reforms the Ministry is undertaking to address the structural inefficiencies at the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG), particularly

in respect of high distribution and commercial losses.

8:35 p.m.

Minister for Energy and Green Transition (Mr John Abdulai Jinapor): Mr Speaker, the losses are generally described as Aggregate, Technical, Collection, and Commercial (A,T,C, and C) losses. Mr Speaker, we have been implementing a series of reforms since assuming office in order

To streamline activities and procurement practices within the ECG operational area.

First of all, what we have done is to realign their procurement needs and to insist that the ECG management strictly adheres to the approved budget ceilings by the board, and we have made it clear that we would not tolerate a situation where management awards contracts outside the remit of the board. Secondly, we have done a needs assessment. Today, ECG has cables that will last 15 years and yet they do not have transformers and so we have realigned their procurement priority to ensure that they really procure what they need.

The ECG management under Ing Julius Kpekpena has terminated 202 contracts so far. These are contracts that we did not find credible in accordance with law. Also, we have implemented a policy where all government agencies except critical agencies are put on prepayment metres. We have cleared about 1,500 containers that were locked at the ports and we have another 1,000 or

so to clear. We are working on that. We have also through Cabinet and Parliament ensured that we give them necessary support to be able to go after the moneys and so far, their revenues are improving. This has led to some significant improvement in revenue collection, in technical losses and in the general performance of ECG, and by the end of the year, we would see that their procurement is far different from what persisted some years ago.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for indulging me and thanks for the responses from the Hon Minister.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister indicates, under reduction of technical and commercial losses, in the second sentence that they are upgrading low-tension lines to low-tension area bundled cables so that they could reduce the technical losses. I would like to find out from him the status of this intervention that the Ministry has put in place.

Thank you.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Thank you, right Mr Speaker.

When we assumed office, a lot of the cables and transformers were obsolete and so what we did was to immediately procure 200 transformers and inject new cables to replace the obsolete cables. If you recall, I had to appear before this House during the initial stages of my office to answer to so many Questions about erratic power supply, particularly

within the Kumasi enclave. As we speak, we have injected a brand-new substation in Kumasi, we have upgraded the cables and you can testify that compared to the initial months the situation has improved significantly.

Thank you very much.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, in the response provided, the Hon Minister has also indicated that there are targeted revenue protection programmes that are being rolled out to strengthen ECG's commercial operations. I would like to know from him how the targeted revenue protection programmes are performing.

Thank you.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, what we do is that, for instance, now if you want to procure ECG credits, you cannot do that on cash basis, so we have reduced the human interface. It is done on an app online, and it is real-time. As Minister, I can go into the system and see for myself real-time how much is collected and how much they are projected to collect.

What we are also ensuring that the cash waterfall mechanism is strictly adhered to, so that in accordance with the proportions and the pro-rata basis that we approved, everybody gets what is due them. This week I am setting a committee to review all these revenue assurance contracts ECG has signed and if we find some not fit for purpose, we either review them, reduce the rates or terminate them. Most of the revenue assurance contracts that we inherited, we have renegotiated them and reduced the

rates. Those who are charging like four or five per cent, we have brought it down to about 2.5 per cent.

Finally, we have further renegotiated with the Independent Power Producers (IPPs) and reduced the amount they collect significantly, and so when you put all this together, it leads to huge significant savings for the State. Thank you.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, this will be my last question on this.

The Hon Minister has indicated that the Ministry is installing prepaid metres for non-strategic ministry departments and agencies. I think that that is a good intervention. However, I would like to find out from him the progress being made on this intervention and how much is the cost involved in installing the prepaid metres in these non-strategic ministries?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Hon Members, the supplementary question can be asked without necessarily repeating the answer of the Minister.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, if you permit me, I would contact ECG and get the exact fine details in terms of the cost, because it is an ongoing process and I did not anticipate that you ask for the cost. You are asking for a specific amount in terms of how much it costs, and I would need to determine that by consulting ECG for the figures.

So, Mr Speaker, if you permit me, once you give me some timelines, I will provide that to the House.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Ranking Member for the Committee on Energy?

Mr George Kwame Aboagye: Thank you, Mr Speaker. If both technical and commercial losses are being paid in the tariff build-up by consumers, and there are proper mechanisms in place to rectify them, why is it that PURC is meeting with stakeholders to try to increase tariffs?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, it is not entirely the case that all the technical losses are absorbed by consumers. If we were to do that, then we would breed and encourage indiscipline and inefficiency. They are given certain benchmarks and certain targets, and the tariff takes those benchmarks and targets into account. So, if ECG misses those benchmarks and targets, it goes against ECG. And if they were a private company, it means that there have been real penal measures from either their directors or stakeholders, and that is where we are going to.

So, even as we increase tariffs, we ensure that those tariffs are linked to performance and improvements and targets that we set for them. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, we move to Question numbered 303, also

standing in the name of Prof Kingsley Nyarko.

Inefficiencies in Power Distribution Sub-Sector

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP — Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the specific interventions the Ministry has taken to reduce the inefficiencies in the power distribution sub-sector of the Ministry.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Nyarko, it appears these two Questions are the same.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, they are not the same.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Minister, you have the floor. Let us hear from you. If they are the same, tell us.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Yes, the distribution sector represents a key component in the entire value chain, because if the distribution sector does not function well, it has a cascading effect. And so, first of all, what we are doing is to set targets for the distribution sector. I have signed agreements with the chief executives, and we are holding them by that.

We have set revenue targets for them. And if you would recall, ECG recently posted a revenue achievement of US\$1.7

billion. We have set some procurement targets for them and indicated that as much as possible, they should conduct competitive tendering, value for money, and ensure that the prices are competitive.

We have set a target for them where under no circumstance should they procure more products when containers are stacked at the port. It is only when they are able to clear them that they can do that. Finally, we have set some losses targets for them, where they are supposed to reduce their technical losses. And so far, the indicators are that we are making significant progress.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

8.45 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko have the floor.

Prof Nyarko: The first question was on ECG specifically.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, you are completely out of order. I refer you to Standing Order 88(7). Please, ask a supplementary question.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, regarding the boundary metering. So far, five operational regions have commenced, and five are remaining; these include Ashanti West, Ashanti East, Ashanti South and Accra East.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, if you do not have a

supplementary question, kindly resume your seat.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am asking. I am saying that in his response, he provided boundary metering as an intervention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I indicated that you can ask a question without repeating the Minister's response. Let us manage the time.

Prof Nyarko: I am not repeating anything. I am saying that he has indicated that five regions have commenced their boundary metering. My question is about the outstanding five, which include Ashanti East, South and West, and Accra East. When are they going to see completion?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister, you have the floor.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, by the end of the year, we will do a detailed assessment of the five so that when we achieve that target, from January, we will start with the remaining five.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further questions?

Prof Nyarko: Yes, Mr Speaker. So the Ministry is supposed to install about 30,000 metres. So far, 3,249 have been done. I would like to know when they are going to install the difference of 26,651.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I have already sent a letter to the Minister for Finance for commencement authorisation to procure the next batch of distribution transformer metres. And so once we get approval, we will immediately commence procurement and install them.

Prof Nyarko: My last follow-up question. With these very good interventions that the Ministry is implementing, will the Minister be able to assure Ghanaians that there will be stability in electricity tariffs? With these interventions, will the Minister be able to assure Ghanaians that regarding—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, will you be able to assure Ghanaians?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Your answer. No repetition of this. We are managing time. Hon Minister, your answer to the question.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, you are not being fair to me. I am not happy about our approach. I want to put it on record.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, what I seek to do is to ensure that there is stability in the supply of power. As we speak, we have hit a new peak load of

4,080 megawatts. What it means is that we need more power in the form of thermal power because we have exhausted our hydro. And any time we bring in thermal power, it means that the cost of production goes up.

So I will leave that for the Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC), which is responsible for tariff setting.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the mass metre replacements and the boundary metering. The Ministry mentioned that they are going to do 313,000. I want to find out the update on those numbers and what the ECG has been able to do.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, if I heard him right, he said 313,000. And, Mr Speaker, I see 30,000 distribution transformer metering. I do not see 313,000 distribution transformers.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. We will take that as an answer.

We will move to question numbered 37, which stands in the name of Dr Ohene Kwame Frimpong, Hon Member for Asante Akim North.

Cause of Intermittent Power Outages in Asante Akim North

Dr Ohene Kwame Frimpong (IND—Asante Akim North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the cause of the intermittent power outages and the low voltage experienced by the people of Asante Akim North.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the Juansa feeder, which serves Asante Akim North under the ECG Konongo District, originates from the Konongo primary substation. The Juansa feeder spans approximately 234.5 circuit kilometres. Its extended length has resulted in low voltage conditions for customers located at the tail end of the line.

Between 1st April and 30th September 2025, the feeder recorded:

- Three (3) unplanned outages
- Five (5) planned outages, broken down as follows:
- Two (2) due to ECG Emergency Load Shedding
- One (1) due to GRIDCo Load Shedding
- Two (2) for corrective maintenance

Network studies conducted on the feeder indicate that injecting a primary substation and creating outgoing feeders

to segment the existing circuit will effectively resolve the voltage challenges.

In the immediate term, Voltage Improvement Technology (VIT) installations have been deployed on the feeder to improve service delivery.

ECG has also initiated a project involving the construction of a 33kV network from the Kumawu substation to Agogo. The civil works on the substation are approximately 85 per cent complete, while electromechanical works are expected to commence soon. The required equipment has arrived at the airport and is currently undergoing clearance procedures.

The route of the 33kV line to supply the substations passes through a forest reserve. ECG is actively engaging with the Forestry Commission to secure the necessary permits.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Dr Frimpong: Yes, Mr Speaker. So, given that the Juansa Feeder spans roughly 234 kilometres, and continues to cause persistent low voltage for the customers—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, ask the question.

Dr Frimpong: Yes, please.

So, I would like to find out from the Minister—Mr Speaker, I must be honest. There is work ongoing in the constituency at the moment. So, I think that it is fair. I will take his Answer. I appreciate it. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, in view of the Minister's Answer, I would like to know how the Ministry intends to ensure restructuring of ECG's management framework to separate commercial operations from technical functions so as to deal with this low voltage situation that is being referenced in this question.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, to separate the commercial or collection from the technical, what we are seeking to do in accordance with our manifesto is to introduce private sector participants in the collection. So, if one has an area or concession, they will be given a target. Or they will do bulk procurement of the power or post the bond. How one collects the money is their problem, so we can focus on the technical aspect. And so, we are in the process of going through that reform. We are procuring a transaction advisor, and very soon we will make progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader. You set the ground rule on your Side before we started.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: That is correct, but not for Leadership. I am just doing two.

8:55 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader, you set the ground rule, or your Side set the ground rule before we started.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: That is correct, but not for Leadership. I am just asking two Questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The ground rule was set to include the Leadership.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, that was not the impression created, but if that impression was created, then please—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I will give you the opportunity to as you last question.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well. That is alright. I appreciate it.

Mr Speaker, in view of the Minister's answer, may I know how the Ministry is ensuring timely maintenance of distribution infrastructure to minimise this situation of low voltage as being experienced?

Mr Speaker, without arguing, the main problem that all reports are bringing up is distribution, distribution losses.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, this is a constituency specific Question. It has to do with Asanti Akim North.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, it is talking about low voltage. It is directly linked to that. The Question has to do with low voltage, and I am saying that low voltage is as a result of imbalanced distribution. My Question to him is, how is the Ministry ensuring timely maintenance—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I said so because mostly, for constituency specific Questions, we limit it to the constituency, particularly in the period in which we are, and based on the ground rules.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you gave the opportunity to just do this one. That is the Question I am asking. I am not asking any more.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, it is the Minister's pleasure that I repeat the question.

Mr Speaker, I want to know from the Hon Minister what measures the Ministry is taking in view of the low voltage concerns to ensure timely maintenance of distribution infrastructure to minimise this low voltage situation being experienced.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In Konongo? In Asante Akin?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Yes, that is the reference point.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minister, you have the floor.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, in relation to that, as I rightly said, we are injecting new feeders there. My information is that by quarter 2 of 2026, that project will be completed. When it is completed, it will really stabilise the supply of power within that enclave. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, we will move to Question numbered 260, standing in the name of Mr Nana Osei-Adjei, New Juaben North. You have the floor.

Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo: Mr Speaker, I have a Question, but it looks like you jumped my question, Question 210.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, yes, you are right. Hon Michael Kwesi Aidoo.

Demand for Power Supply to Households and Industry

Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (NPP — Oforikrom): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition why the Government has not been able to meet the demand for power supply to households and industries. Thank you.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, on the contrary, we are able to meet the nation's

demand for power, and I can inform this House that for about seven months now, continuous, we have not had load shedding. We have enough and even though today, as I have said, we have reached a new peak demand of 4080MW. We are still holding very tight.

Mr Speaker, Ghana's current electricity demand including households and industries (generation capacity of 5.7GW against Peak Demand of about 4GW) is largely being met.

However, there are occasional interruptions in power supply caused by disturbances in the generation and transmission networks, temporary gas supply disruptions, and localized faults. Whenever these occur, the Ministry and its agencies take prompt corrective measures to restore supply.

In the medium to long term, the Ministry is implementing measures to ensure that the projected annual demand growth of about 370 MW, including the required reserve margin, is adequately met through generation expansion, fuel security, and grid reinforcement initiatives. Mr Speaker, on the contrary, we are able to meet the nation's demand for power. And I can inform the South that for about seven months now, it continues. We haven't had load shedding.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

Mr Aidoo: Mr Speaker, I would like to know from the Minister if there are

any projects ongoing or in advance planning which is expected to add additional capacity to our generation. And what are the timelines for completion?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, we have about three main projects in the pipeline by Volta River Authority, Cenit Energy Limited, and Aksa Generator Ghana. We expect that the Aksa plant will come on stream in the first week, or maximum second week of December. We expect that quarter 1, the VRA plant will come online and we expect that quarter 2, the Cenit plant will come on board. The combined effect of these plants is that we could potentially generate 500 additional megawatts. We are also working with Aksa to bring on board 500 megawatts by second quarter of 2027. Thank you very much,

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any further question?

Mr Aidoo: Mr Speaker, I want to know if we owe any of our gas suppliers, taking into consideration the GHC1 levy approved in this House, which generates about GHC450 million monthly. If we do —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, look at the Question that you have asked, and relate it to the supplementary question that we are asking, and see whether it emanates from the Question. If you are owing a supplier, what has it got to do—

Mr Aidoo: Mr Speaker, I am asking the question based on the answer given by the Minister from the *Order Paper*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Where did the Minister state that he is owing?

Mr Aidoo: Mr Speaker, if you look at the answer, the Minister indicated from his answer that on paragraph 2, “However, there are occasional interruptions in power supply caused by disturbances in the generation and transmission networks, temporary gas supply disruptions, and localized faults.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What has to go to do with owing a supplier?

Mr Aidoo: If there are temporary gas supply disruptions—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the Question is overruled. Ask another question.

Mr Aidoo: Mr Speaker, beyond the current gas supply agreements, what steps is the Ministry taking to get reliable fuel supply, and what contingency arrangements are in place to maintain generation should there be a prolonged disruption to our main gas supply?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, when we assumed office, liquid fuels were the order of the day. Within this short period, we have been able to increase gas production by 50 MMscf: 20 MMscf by Jubilee Partners and 30 MMscf by Eni Ghana. That has significantly improved

fuel supply, culminating in reliable supply of power. Going forward, we are working with Eni to bring on board additional 70MMscf. We are working with the Jubilee Partners to bring on board another 70MMscf with a second gas processing plant, and we believe that if we are able to achieve those targets, we will further improve power supply. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any last supplementary? Yes, Ranking Member for the Committee on Energy?

Mr George Kwame Aboagye (NPP — Asene/Manso/Akroso): Mr Speaker, Hon Minister said current generation capacity of 5.7 GW, and then peak demand is 4 GW. I do not understand. I just want to understand. You need to explain further. You said generation capacity or installed capacity. If it is generation capacity, then the difference is the remaining one, what are we doing with it?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have asked the Question. Minister, answer.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I said “installed capacity”. Your installed capacity can also be your potential generation capacity. On a daily basis, not all the plants function. That is why then move to available capacity and dependable capacity. You do not rate it just on generation capacity or installed capacity, but by what is readily available and producing. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move to Question numbered 260 standing in the name of Nana Osei-Adjei, New Juaben North.

9.05 p.m.

Extension of Electricity to Asogya

Mr Nana Osei-Adjei (NPP — New Juaben North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the steps the Ministry is implementing to extend electricity to the people of Asogya near Asikasu. Thank you.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: The Asogya community does not form part of any of the on-going projects currently being executed by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition. The community has been noted and would be considered when funds become available. But fortunately the Minister for Finance has assured that in the 2026 Budgetary provision. I therefore what to assure my Hon Colleague that once the Budget is approved, I will work on this community and capture it as part of the communities we intend to electrify. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Mr Osei-Adjei: Thank you very much Mr Speaker. I thank the Minister for the assurance, so I will be looking out for the assurance given to the people of Asogya.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is a constituency-specific Question. We will move to the Question numbered 300, standing in the name of Hon Maxwell Kwame Lukutor, Member of Parliament for South Tongu.

Removal of Weeds around Lower Volta Bridge at Sogakope

Ing. Surv. Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (NDC—South Tongu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans of the Ministry for the continuous removal of water weeds in the Volta River especially around the lower Volta Bridge at Sogakope.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, Mr Speaker, the following are the efforts and initiatives taken by the Volta River Authority on the subject matter:

- i. The Volta River Authority (VRA) has, for over three decades, operated aquatic weed harvesting equipment on the Lower Volta River as part of its corporate social responsibilities, in supporting shoreline communities and preserving the ecological integrity of the river system. At present, the Authority's weed harvesting equipment are undergoing major rehabilitation to restore full operational capacity and ensure sustained impact.
- ii. In the immediate term, the VRA is prioritising the rehabilitation of its core aquatic weed-harvesting equipment. These include:
 - VRA's Weed Harvester, Conver C-90, which is specifically designed to harvest submerged

and floating aquatic vegetation efficiently.

- A Skimmer, generously provided by the Ghana Maritime Authority, to support surface-level weed collection in 2022.

The Conver C-90 and the Skimmer are currently undergoing repair works and are scheduled to be fully operational by the end of this year. Once commissioned, these vessels will be deployed regularly under the Sogakope Bridge to undertake sustainable weed clearance operations.

In the long term, the Volta River Authority is restoring additional support vessels, including tugboats and minibarges, currently under repair to operational status by December, 2025. These vessels will provide critical logistical support by transporting personnel, equipment, and harvested biomass, thereby enabling uninterrupted field operations along key weed-infested zones in the Lower Volta area.

I have directed, as Minister, that all these machines be repaired so they can commence work. My information is that work is ongoing and by the end of the year, those machines should be ready to be deployed.

Ing. Surv Lukutor: Beyond the regular or routine waste removal, are there any plans from the Ministry or the VRA to engage private business people who are interested in using these weeds or converting them into organic fertiliser, paper, animal feed and even waste water treatment chemicals?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, we have not considered that yet, but coming from the MP from the area, we would be very much willing to partner with him to explore this option.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary question?

Ing. Surv Lukutor: No, Mr Speaker, just to say thank you to the Hon Minister.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This is also a constituency-specific question. Question numbered 301, standing in the name of Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan, Member of Parliament for Yendi. Hon Member, I stated that is a constituency-specific question. Hon Member, I indicated that this has got to do with Sogakope. Yes, Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan, you have the floor.

Current State of Rural Electrification Projects in Kpasani et al

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (NDC — Yendi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the current state of the ongoing rural electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Kpasani (ii) Warikpomo (iii) Pion Kamonaayili (iv) Zakolinyen Bologni Neibong (v) Oseido (vi) Adoyili (vii) Klunkpanga.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Kpasani, Warikpomo, Pion Kamonaayili, Zakolinyen Bologni Neibong, Oseido, Adoyili and Klunkpanga communities form part of the Ministry of Energy and

Green Transition's ongoing SHEP-4 Rural Electrification Project in the Yendi Constituency of the Northern Region.

A total of 391no. High Voltage (HV) poles required for the communities have been supplied. Most of the required pole-top materials have also been supplied. 167no. HV poles have been planted and strung in Zakolinyen Bologni, Andoyili and Klunkpanga communities. 218no. HV poles have been planted and awaiting stringing in Kpasani, Neibong, Oseido and Warikpomo communities.

The transformer for Zakolinyen Bologni community has been released and mounted at site. The transformer will be dressed upon release of the substation materials. 218 out of 315 no. Low Voltage (LV) poles required for the project have been supplied and planted in Zakolinyen Bologni, Neibong, Oseido, Andoyili and Klunkpanga communities. The requisite pole-top accessories have also been supplied and conductor stringing is currently underway in the communities.

Pion Yipala community does not form part of the scope of works in the contract for the electrification project. The materials (poles) which were meant for installation at Pion Kamonaayili were inadvertently delivered to Pion Yipala during transportation to site. This is attributed to the resemblance in the names of the communities.

This has resulted in delay in installation works in the two communities. The Ministry is making arrangement to include Pion Yipala

community in the electrification project to allow for supply of materials and continuation of installation works in the two communities.

The delay in the execution of the electrification projects in these communities is also partly due to shortages of some key materials/equipment including concrete pole accessories, LV poles and meters. The Ministry is taking steps to procure some of these materials to allow for completion of the electrification projects. The Ministry expects to complete installation work in these communities by the end of the second quarter of 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr A. F. Alhassan: Mr Speaker, that would be all for that Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This is also a constituency-specific Question.

Question numbered 302 also standing in the name of Hon Adbul-Fatawu Alhassan, MP for Yendi.

Rural Electrification Projects in Baaduli and others

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (NDC — Yendi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the state of the ongoing rural electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Baaduli (ii) Kpalsogni (iii) Nasal Achiriyili (iv) Jembogni (v) Bunbun Yapala

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the communities of Baaduli, Kpalsogni, Nasal Achiriyili, Jembogni, and Bunbun Yapala form part of the on-going Self-Help Electrification Programme (SHEP-4) being implemented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition in the Yendi Constituency of the Northern Region.

Out of the 119 high-voltage (HV) poles required for the project, 54 poles have been supplied and planted at Nasal Achiriyili and Kpalsogni. Conductor stringing has been completed at Nasal Achiriyili, and a transformer installed, awaiting final dressing upon receipt of the remaining substation materials.

Most pole-top accessories required for these locations have also been delivered to site. In addition, 40 out of 247 low-voltage (LV) poles have been supplied and strung at Nasal Achiriyili, while some accessories have been delivered to Baaduli, Kpalsogni, and Jembogni.

However, poles and accessories for Baaduli, Jembogni, and Bunbun Yapala are yet to be supplied. The delay in project execution is mainly due to shortages of key materials and equipment, including LV poles, concrete pole accessories, and energy meters.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry is actively procuring the outstanding materials to facilitate the completion of these electrification works and expects to complete installation in all five communities by the end of the second quarter of 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr A. F. Alhassan: No, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We move to Question numbered 305, standing in the name of Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan, MP for Yendi.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I know there are ground rules on the Question a Member asks. But Mr Speaker, I would want you to indulge me because I am a very good friend and the chief warrior of Yendi. So, if you would permit me, I just have a supplementary question for him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. I will permit you one supplementary question.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I just want to find out from the Hon Minister whether these are part of the projects that were awarded by the previous government, and when were they awarded?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, some of the contract for these communities were even awarded before I left office. So, one can imagine that it is taken very long. But like he said, the Ya-Na is my paternal grandfather, so I have a strong relationship with Yendi and I will ensure that the communities are hooked on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We move to Question numbered 305 also standing in the name of —

Rural Electrification Project in Sunsongbun and others

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (NDC — Yendi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the current state of the rural electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Sunsongbun (ii) Kpatiya (iii) Nalogu Kpanji (iv) Banchiyili 1 & 2 (v) Kulkpeni (vi) Kpalsonado.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the communities of Sunsongbun, Kpatiya, Nalogu, Kpanji, Banchiyili 1 & 2, Kulkpeni, and Kpalsonado form part of the on-going Self-Help Electrification Programme (SHEP-4) being implemented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition in the Yendi Constituency of the Northern Region.

Out of the 285 high-voltage (HV) concrete poles required for the project, 198 poles have been supplied and planted across the beneficiary communities. Conductor stringing has been completed at Sunsongbun, Kpanji, and Kpalsonado, with transformers installed in both Kpanji and Kpalsonado. Most of the required pole-top accessories have also been delivered to the remaining communities. Similarly, 132 out of 292 low-voltage (LV) concrete poles have been supplied and planted, along with a portion of the necessary accessories.

The delays in implementation are mainly due to shortages of key materials and equipment, including concrete pole accessories and energy meters. However,

the Ministry has received some of the outstanding materials and is arranging their release to allow work to progress.

Additionally, the Ministry is procuring meters to facilitate customer service connections. The electrification works in these communities are expected to be completed by the end of the second quarter of 2026.

Mr A. F. Alhassan: Mr Speaker, I have no further questions, but I just want to commend the Minister, especially with regards to the answers given. He has given specific timelines, especially with the fact that all the projects are expected to be completed by the end of second quarter of 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We move to Question number 306. Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister must answer this question. He should not dodge this and say that Ya-Na is his grandfather. Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Minister when the contracts for communities listed in the Question were awarded and would be completed.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, as I said, some of the contract for these communities were awarded as far back as 2016. In terms of completion of award, they will be completed before the second quarter of next year.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, order! Question numbered 306 stands in the name of Dr Thomas

Winsum Anabah, Member of Parliament for Garu.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

9:15 p.m.

Rampant Power Fluctuations and Supply Interruptions in Garu and Adjoining Districts

Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (NDC — Garu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the measures the Ministry is taking to resolve the rampant power fluctuation (low current) and frequent interruption of power supply to Garu and adjoining districts like Tempane and Nakpanduri.

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, the challenges of intermittent power supply and low voltage being experienced in Garu and adjoining districts such as Tempane, Nakpanduri, Yunyoo, and Nalerigu are primarily due to the configuration and operational limitations of the Bawku–Garu–Gambaga–Bunkprugu feeder, technically designated as Feeder 73Y2F1, operated by the Northern Electricity Distribution Company (NEDCo).

This feeder supplies electricity at 34.5 kV from the Bawku Switching Station and traverses a total length of approximately 600 kilometres, serving 402 distribution transformers across five (5) districts and portions of the East Mamprusi Municipality. The extensive length of the feeder, coupled with

multiple tee-offs serving numerous communities, makes it highly vulnerable to network losses, voltage drops, and frequent interruptions.

Mr Speaker, the major causes identified include:

1. Aging network infrastructure such as wooden poles, insulators, and accessories.
2. Overgrown vegetation and environmental interference, which cause line faults and short circuits.
3. Adverse weather conditions, particularly heavy storms that damage network components.
4. Security challenges in the Bawku–Denugu–Garu stretch, which have limited routine maintenance activities.

Despite these constraints, NEDCo has undertaken several maintenance and reinforcement activities in 2025 to stabilise supply, including:

1. Feeder Maintenance (Bawku–Denugu–Garu stretch):
 - 1) Vegetation control and tree pruning along the steel tower line (STL).
 - 2) Replacement of 42 disc insulators and rectification of 27 loose members.
 - 3) Removal of 27 bird nests affecting insulator performance.

2. Medium Voltage Network Maintenance (Garu Service Area):

- 1) Replacement of 17 disc insulators, 10 pin insulators, and 1 drop-out fuse.
- 2) Vegetation control over a 26 km stretch and patrol of 52 km of line.

3. Sub-transmission Network Works (Nakpanduri–Nalerigu–Gambaga):

- 1) Vegetation control along 38 km of high-tension lines.
- 2) Replacement of 33 disc insulators, 86 bolts and nuts, and 80 missing tower members.

5. Network Reinforcement:

- Replacement of 81 defective wooden poles with steel and concrete poles to strengthen the network and minimize storm-related collapses.

Proposed and Ongoing Measures

In addition to the above, the following medium and long-term interventions are being pursued:

Short-term Measures:

- Construction of an 8 km line from Langbinsi to Mimima to establish an alternative supply path from Pwalugu to the East Mamprusi Municipality.

- Network reconfiguration in Garu to reduce the number of tee-offs and improve power flow.
- Creation of a bypass line at Nakpanduri to enhance operational flexibility and reduce downtime.
- Installation of Auto-Reclosers to provide fault segregation, minimize widespread outages, and improve system protection.

Long-term Measures:

- Establishment of a Switching Station at Gambaga, to provide independent feeders for Bunkprugu, Gambaga, and Garu, with the new source of supply from the Zebilla Bulk Supply Point (BSP).

Mr Speaker, the Ministry, working with NEDCo, remains committed to ensuring reliable electricity supply to all parts of the Northern Region. However, the persistent security situation in the Bawku area continues to impede full-scale maintenance operations along the Bawku–Garu section of the feeder.

The Ministry is therefore engaging relevant state security agencies to facilitate safe access for NEDCo maintenance teams, while simultaneously pursuing the Gambaga Switching Station project and

Langbinsi–Mimima line extension to permanently resolve the voltage and outage challenges in Garu and its adjoining districts.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Dr Anabah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Hon Minister, thank you very much for your answer. But I would like to know how soon these short-term measures that you have well elaborated that would bring relief to the people begin?

Mr J. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, we have outlined some few short-term measures; the construction of an eight-kilometre line, network reconfiguration, the creation of a bypass, and the installation of auto reclosers to provide fault segregation. All this, we intend to do the 2026 fiscal year.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary question?

Dr Anabah: No more questions. Thank you, Mr Speaker, and I thank the Minister for the answers.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Question time has ended. We move to the next item, Statements.

Hon Minister, you are duly discharged. We thank you very much for attending upon the House and providing answers to Questions.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I was just relating with the Majority Leader that it is past 9 p.m. We are tired. For the Statements, if we can postpone till tomorrow.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: All right.

Hon Members, the application is to postpone the Statements till tomorrow. What is the pleasure of the House?

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: The indication is that Members are tired. So, we are in your hands. It is past five hours.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think we have sat in excess of five hours. Therefore, I would stand on the relevant Standing Orders, particularly Order 156, and proceed to adjourn the House.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 9:23 p.m. till Wednesday, 12th November, 2025, at 2:00 p.m.

